

Our Mission Statement

To facilitate the successful integration of individuals & communities of non-English speaking background, into Australian life, in an environment sensitive & responsive to their needs

OFFICE LOCATIONS

LOCATION	POSTAL ADDRESS	PHONE	FAX	EMAIL
HAMILTON (Head Office) 8 Chaucer Street Hamilton NSW 2303	As location	4969 3399	4961 4997	nss@nsservices.com.au
CENTRAL COAST Tuggerah Lakes Community Centre 1 Bay Village Road Bateau Bay NSW 2261	PO Box 4167 Bay Village NSW 2261	4334 3877	4334 3044	cc@nsservices.com.au
ARMIDALE Hughes House 141 Faulkner Street Armidale NSW 2350 (behind Kent House)	PO Box 1781 Armidale NSW 2350	6771 3975	6771 3691	nssarm@bigpond.com
TAMWORTH Suite 10 56-58 Dowe Street Tamworth NSW 2340	As location	6766 5070	Not avail.	nsstam@nsservices.com.au

SERVICE REGIONS

Hunter Outreach – Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens, Maitland, Cessnock, Singleton, Muswellbrook, Dungog, Scone, Merriwa & Murrurundi.

Central Coast – Gosford & Wyong

Northern Tablelands – Tamworth & Armidale

Other Regions Supported – North West & Central West NSW

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Board of Management - 30 June 2014

Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM	Chair, Finance & Audit Committee
Ms Irina Lupish	Vice Chair
Ms Christine Jordan	Treasurer, Public Officer, Finance & Audit Committee
Mr James Garvey	Assistant Treasurer, Finance & Audit Committee
Ms Sania Young	Secretary, Finance & Audit Committee
Mr Jon Chin	Assistant Secretary, Finance & Audit Committee
Mr Zoran Vasiljevic	Director
Ms Anna Marendy	Director
Father Nicholas Zervas OAM	Director
Ms Esther Kalenga	Director
Mr Biko Syongoh	Director
Cr. Tim Crakanthorp	Co-opted Member, Newcastle City Council
Cr. Therese Doyle	Co-opted Member, Newcastle City Council
Barney Langford	Co-opted Member, Lake Macquarie City Council

Staff – 30 June 2014

Chief Executive Officer

Migration Agents
Finance Manager
Finance Officer
Acting Operations Manager
Administration
WH&S Consultant

Lulu Tantos

Lulu Tantos & Henriette de Jong
Foong Rina Lachlan
Samira Davoodi * & Kathy Rowarth
Enza Di Stefano
Losa Uata* & Natasha Holliday
Helen Buchanan

Rural Support Team Manager

Hunter Welfare Outreach SGP
New England SGP Worker (Tamworth)
New England SGP Worker (Armidale)

Alex Burns

Rose Oku
Amalin Sundaravej
Judith Roberts

Central Coast Team Manager

Office Administration
Office Administration
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinator
Settlement Grants Program (SGP) Worker
Multicultural Community Development Workers

Alex Burns

Sharlene Huber
Marilyn Perez Cabrera
Marilyn Perez Cabrera
Anita Trainor
Kellie Matterson
Nellie Srisurapon
Pari Batha & Natalia Meliendrez

Aged Services Team Manager/Community Aged Care Packages Coordinator

Community Aged Care Packages Coordinator
Community Aged Care Packages Coordinator
Hunter Multicultural Respite Service Coordinator
Community Visitors Scheme Coordinator
Multicultural Access Project Worker

Sue Hristov

Lupe Fonua
Tima 'Oto
Tima 'Oto
Enza Di Stefano
Rasa Bajalis

Settlement Support & Communities Team Manager

Settlement Grant Project Workers
CALD Youth Worker -SGP
Life Skills & Parenting Groups/ Refugee Programs Project Officer
Congolese Family Support Workers
Volunteers Coordinator (Educational Programs)
Volunteers Coordinator (Welfare Programs)

Alex Burns

Lydia Manusiu & Emilie Wiggers*
Tonkoh Kamara
Helen Buchanan
Kwabo Batende* & Marie Zawadi
Michael Freund
Emilie Wiggers*

Welfare Team Leader / Multicultural Welfare Worker

Multicultural Family Worker (Families NSW)
Multicultural Welfare Worker / EAPA
Multicultural Welfare Worker
Multicultural Welfare Worker
Multicultural Welfare Worker
Brighter Futures Coordinators

Petrona Kelly

Miza Torlakovic
Juanita Loli
Finau Manu
Elena Ferguson
Lydia Manusiu
Zenaida Edmunds & Desie Erhart

Tax Help

Tax Help Assistants

Tima 'Oto & Juanita Loli

*Indicates is no longer with the organisation, at time of print

Year in review

Funding Partnerships

-  **Department of Social Services**
-  **NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services**
-  **NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services (HACC)**
-  **Families NSW**
-  **ClubsNSW**
-  **The Benevolent Society**
-  **Gosford City Council**

Our Supporters

We wish to acknowledge and thank all our stakeholders for their continued support of the many and diverse programs delivered throughout the past year.

Networks & Interagencies



Northern Settlement Services supports a range of networks including the Mid North Coast, North Coast & Hunter Rural Multicultural Networks; the Central West, Central Coast, Newcastle & New England Multicultural Interagencies; the Hunter Refugee Network and the Hunter CALD Aged & Disability Services Network.



Chairperson's Report

Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM

During the past year the management and staff at NSS has shown they are very committed and professional despite some difficult circumstances.

We had a number of gaps in administration and finance staff for various reasons, maternity leave, moving to other places and jobs. This meant that the remaining staff had to pick up the slack. We thank them very much for their cooperation, especially Enza Di Stefano who agreed to act in the position of Operations Manager.

Last year has been particularly difficult for senior staff as there were many changes in Federal Funding bodies (see CEO report) which meant a large workload in grant applications for senior staff. Like the previous year we were successful with quite a number of grants. These have also benefitted provision of services in the Central Coast.

I would like to give a special mention to the staff in our satellite offices who provide a great service to the communities of Northern NSW and Central Coast. I would like to single out Alex Burns to thank him for the many years of mentoring and supervising of staff and always travelling to support workers in these places (for details see separate reports).

Congratulations should go to Nellie Srisurapon who was a finalist in the Case Worker of the Year Category for the Migration & Settlement Awards in Canberra - well done.

I am especially pleased to see the Chinese Social Support Service established; this group has been difficult to access over the years.

I also wish to thank Clubs NSW for the generous funding support we have received over the years including the past year for the Home Work Centres.

Our focus on children and families continues, with the expansion of the playgroups to more outlying areas of the Hunter (see reports).

All in, it has again been a successful year in the provision of services to the multicultural communities in the Hunter, Central Coast and Northern NSW, despite the many changes at a Federal Level in funding arrangements and I wish to thank our dedicated and committed staff for coping so well with the extra work required.

NSS has had a sound financial year, due to a variety of factors including ownership of our building with less interest payments, staff movements, contribution by SSI for rent etc. Also the delay in renovations of the eastern part of the building and the appointment of staff into vacated positions will see the surplus reduced in the new year.

I would further like to thank my fellow Board members for their continued commitment and support and contribution and giving of their time to NSS.

Our excellent reputation and achievements are due to our dedicated management and staff and on behalf of the Board I wish to thank all of you.

I wish everyone a healthy, successful and fulfilling year ahead.

Trudy Mills-Evers AM
Chair



Chief Executive Officer's Report

Ms Lulu Tantos

I must first thank the Board of Management & our staff & volunteers for their continued commitment. It has been another successful year with many noteworthy initiatives and I refer to the reports from the various department managers and the progress they and their teams are making across the organisation. NSS is fortunate to have such high calibre senior management to steer NSS through the busy times.

With so much uncertainty in the air leading up to the Federal elections in September 2013, it has been an opportunity to reflect on our core values as an organisation ensuring that:

- our clients have a voice and are heard
- our stakeholder relationships are valued and nurtured
- we continue to provide quality services to vulnerable communities and most importantly that:
- clients are treated with dignity and humanity

To achieve our organisational priorities we need to be able to have a sense of compassion for our clients and our communities; we need to be committed and loyal to our organisation and colleagues; we need to have integrity in our approach. At NSS, irrelevant of government policies, we need to ensure that we are doing the best possible job we can for our communities and we do it without compromising our values.

Our staff & volunteers are committed to delivering the best quality service within the constraints of government funding to support our clients not only on arrival in our community, but also during the different stages of their settlement journey; that they are supported and resourced to fulfil their potential as members of the Australian community.

NSS holds firmly the view that well-funded settlement programs are a valuable investment for all Australians. It allows government, settlement service providers and community to work collaboratively to ensure that the newly arrived are provided opportunities to meet their full economic & social potential.

While a commitment to Multiculturalism was demonstrated in the budget, the "proof will be in the pudding" when government tenders are announced in December 2014 affecting settlement programs and services moving forward.

The year has also been punctuated by several key changes in a number of government departments including:

- The introduction of the National Disability Insurance Scheme on 1st July 2013
- Aged Care reforms in response to the growing population of older people & the challenges facing the current aged care system

Post-election, 18th September 2013 also saw:

- The establishment of the new ('mega') Department of Social Services which has now become one of only two key NSS funding bodies, (the other being the NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services) with responsibilities in a number of portfolios but most importantly for us in Settlement & Multicultural Affairs, Ageing & Aged Care, and Families & Children. The true impact of this change on our organisation is still evolving

Other highlights during the year included:

- Expansion to the Community Visitors Scheme in Newcastle and on the Central Coast
- Continued support of the Homework Centres by ClubsNSW
- The establishment of the Chinese Social Support Service with funding received through Commonwealth HACC program, to assist older people in the Chinese Community participate in community life.
- The establishment of playgroups at Singleton and Raymond Terrace in partnership with Hunter Prelude & First Chance respectively to assist in breaking social isolation by connecting families with local community; and in Warners Bay with Lake Macquarie City Council and The Willows Uniting Church.
- Successful Harmony Day and Refugee Week events across our geographic region.
- Recognition by the FACS contracting team of the NSS Central Coast team for their continued professional practice. In addition to this Nellie Srisurapon, our SGP worker on the Central Coast was one of 3 finalists nominated in the Case Worker of the Year category for the Migration & Settlement Awards in Canberra.

I wish to thank our funding bodies because without them NSS would be less able to deliver on the outcomes reported by the NSS team. We have so many wonderful partners we collaborate with, your expertise and genuine interest in working with us makes us stronger and more relevant to the community. In particular I would like to recognise our close association and collaboration with Settlement Services International (SSI) which NSS hosts at head office and led by Debbie Carstens, providing services in the areas of asylum seeker assistance and multicultural foster care. Sharing a similar vision we welcome the contribution and quality services and support they provide not only to vulnerable communities in NSW but to settlement agencies like ours.

I also wish to warmly acknowledge the Board of Management who together work with staff to ensure we stay true to our vision. They hold honorary positions and their committed leadership is valued as it is central to our success as an organisation. To our management team, your industry knowledge and passion are the keys to how we manage our critical role going forward.

Lulu Tantos
CEO

Settlement Grants Program



Funded by
Department of Social Services



Settlement Support & Communities Team Manager

Alex Burns

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

This position provides leadership, assistance, mentoring and resourcing to the NSS settlement support and community team and other rural funded Settlement Services Programs (SGP) in their provision of settlement support to highly vulnerable new arrival refugees, family and other permanent visa holders in Northern and Western NSW. It also provides management and support to two other NSS projects on the Central Coast, the Community Builders Project and the Multicultural Social Support Service.

The growth area for 2013-14 in our settlement services work has been youth related. In particular youth disengagement from school and young people needing to access social activities often a reflection of what the settlement experience brings. Coinciding with this has been the arrival of new refugees in Newcastle with increasing number of Afghani settlers.

Other work as the Team manager Settlement and Community support has been with the Community Builders program that addresses the Central Coast and focuses NSS in its work with the CALD Communities in that area. As in previous years the work has been constructive and rewarding in its variety.

In addition we have the Multicultural Social Support Service, built on face to face client work with Volunteers supporting a client group of well over 100 people. This service has also expanded and has several strong social groups, one being a Spanish speaking group and the other being the Italian community group.

Rural Support Work- Alex Burns

Table 1: Face to Face Work and Visits to Regional and Rural SGP Projects in Northern and Western NSW, 2013-2014

Location	Visits	Location	Visits
Manning Valley	4	Coffs Harbour	3
Lismore	2	Armidale	6
Tamworth	6	Bathurst	3
Dubbo	2	Orange	3
Hunter Outreach	10+		

This last 12 months has seen a slightly higher visitation to the rural based SGP projects. The Worker continues to provide case work advice for the other rural based SGP services.

- Supported 8 SGP project workers outside of Newcastle to address the needs of more than 15 client cases. And a further 3 workers with 15 cases (mainly Afghani) in the home area of NSS.
- 4 cases related to African Refugees and 2 Burmese in New England and 4 Africans (Congolese) in the Newcastle area with issues around Family Day Care, employment, Domestic Violence (DV), family relationships and child protection.

- Other cases related to a Tamil born humanitarian client, 6 Thai, 2 Ethiopian, 1 Somali as well as a number of Family Stream clients, especially from Thailand with the largest number of issues relating to accommodation and DV matters.
- the continued lack of use of Interpreters by services in their dealings with clients of the SGP projects
- the impact of specific Visa type entrants into the geography of the SGP projects including Visa 475 regional employment and the Visa 457 type
- The main referrals were to services in respect of Family Day Care, Department of Human Services, Housing organizations and real estate agents, NAVITAS, TAFE, schools, health and mental health. Numerous emails were responded to in respect of client or client associated matters.

Work with the Rural Based SGP project included participating in various meetings to support and promote the work of the Rural based, and all NSS, SGP projects, especially at meetings in their regions, or at ones in Sydney. Primary among these was attendance at the various multicultural Interagencies and networks including the North Coast Migrant Workers now Coffs Harbour Network, the Mid North Coast Multicultural Network, the New England Multicultural Interagency, the Central West Orana Multicultural Interagency as well as the Hunter Refugee Network, the Navitas local area committee, the Newcastle Multicultural Interagency and the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency. At the regional level I participated in the TAFE regional Meeting, the FACS regional meeting the CRC Central Coast RAC meeting, while at the state level the regular meetings included the State FACS MAAG meeting, the DIAC SPF meeting, The Centrelink (Human Services) MAF meeting and the CRC Settlement providers meeting.

Consultations with communities have included:

- A meeting to establish the Multicultural Tamworth Group
- A meeting with the Chinese Community of Newcastle re: formation of a social support group
- A meeting of the combined Central Coast CALD groups
- Acting as returning officer for the Newcastle Congolese Community

Participation at events included several Harmony Day Events in Newcastle, Lake Macquarie and Cessnock, Refugee week in Newcastle- the picnic in the park, the SGP Rural Conference, the FECCA conference, 2 Lake Macquarie Citizenship ceremonies and numerous other meetings. Finally the other work area of this position has been to support the whole organisation with the writing of funding applications with one of these being around the area of Disaster Preparedness, an area that NSS has had a long history while others relate to our ongoing settlement, family and parenting, volunteering and promotion of services to address aging CALD communities. We look forward to the success of these.

It has been another very busy year.

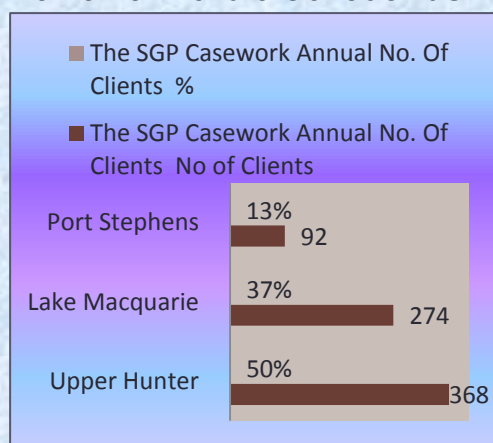


Hunter Welfare Outreach Settlement Grants Program

Rose Oku

Funded by
Department of Social Services

The Hunter Welfare Outreach SGP project provides support services to newly arrived, highly disadvantaged refugees and migrants, especially women who are experiencing hardship through isolation, domestic violence, homelessness and other misfortunes encountered in their settlement. The program covers Port Stephens, Lake Macquarie and Upper Hunter Areas.



Casework Clients by service area - Upper Hunter (368): Muswellbrook, Singleton, Cessnock, Maitland and Rutherford; Port Stephens (92): Raymond Terrace, Nelson Bay, Shoal Bay and Karuah; Lake Macquarie (274): Belmont, Toronto, Charlestown, Redhead, Speers Point, Windale and Valentine.

Casework. The Settlement Grants Project Outreach Worker continued to provide face to face casework to the target groups in isolated parts of the Hunter, Port Stephens and Lake Macquarie areas. The client group comprises people from several African nations, India, Bangladesh, Nepal, Philippines, Indonesia, Peru, Thailand, Sri Lanka, Korea, Japan, Pakistan, Fiji, China and many more. The object is to ensure their needs are met, by referring them to a wide range of community resources and services such as child protection, employment, domestic violence, family mediation, tenancy tribunal, accommodation, advocacy, Centrelink, interpreters, childcare facilities, education and training services. During 2013-2014 the SGP supported 734 Client Contacts - 97% received an average of between 20-40 minutes in consultation, depending upon the complexity of the case and if the client needed an interpreter more time was required. Casework is diverse and complex as recently arrived high needs clients, are unsure of how to access services in the community when they require extra support. On average these clients were dealing with a wide range of issues that included: Family relationships, Accommodation, Language problems, Accessing Interpreters, Advocacy Support, Isolation, Domestic Violence, Financial Assistance, Legal, Health, Document Help, Education, Training, and Employment.



Group Work: Multicultural Friendship Groups have been developed in different locations at Singleton, Tomaree and Cessnock. There were 31 Information sessions held during 2013-2014 addressing, health, isolation, education, volunteering in the community, community capacity building, family relationships, and employment issues. Overall the SGP attended 8 major community events and activities during the year.

The Hunter Valley Multicultural Friendship Group (HVMFG) at Cessnock in partnership with other local organizations, participated in 2 Harmony Day celebrations. The Singleton Women's Group continue to support the Red Cross Morning Tea in August to raise funds for the Red Cross. On 29th March the group also celebrated Harmony Day at Singleton Library with storytelling activities for children and later with the wider community through dance, food and singing. The Tomaree Friendship Group celebrated Harmony Day on 24th March 2014. All groups continue to participate in Health Information Sessions on a varied range of topics to support clients' needs these included; healthy eating for families, depression, dental health, the poverty program, parent and child relationships, falls prevention and the quit smoking program. These sessions were presented in partnership with other organisations, for example, Community Health, Centrelink, Hunter New England Health, Red Cross Organization, Relay for Life, Tenancy Advice Service, and NSW TAFE.

The 2nd Annual Riverlights Festival was held in Maitland in October 2013. Again, the multicultural Groups from Maitland LGA, Cessnock, Singleton and Lake Macquarie participated in this event. It was a great success with the community coming together to celebrate Multicultural Diversity. Different activities were included like Multicultural children's games and craft activities so the wider Australian community could learn how to play simple childhood games and crafts from other cultures.

Singleton Multicultural Parenting Program

In February 2014 in partnership with Hunter Prelude, and Singleton Council, NSS met to develop an initial 6 month plan to establish a Singleton Multicultural Parenting Program to link CALD families to their local community and promote child development. Discussions were initiated with Singleton's Women's Friendship Group about new project and the group's participants were given a choice on how the program should be implemented. It was decided that the playgroup would be held at Singleton Hunter Prelude as there is no cost for hire, the environment and playground equipment is safe. Families are linked into their local community, as they learn about the library systems such as borrowing books in their own language and for children to extend on concentration and literacy skills. The parents interact with their children and learn more about child development. Parents are encouraged to access mainstream services and two now access local mainstream playgroups.



Raymond Terrace and surrounds Multicultural Playtime

This parenting group started in April 2014 for the Raymond Terrace Community and surrounding areas and is in partnership with First Chance and Thou-Walla Family Services Centre. The whole family is encouraged to participate in family orientated activities including play activities, networking, parent/carer support with children's development. The opening of the group's activities was enjoyed with a special cook-up.

Promotional Activities and Networking. The SGP worker attended over 46 promotional activities and networking events. These included an invite to a school to talk about cultural awareness, social justice and share personal experiences coming from another country. The worker continues in the role as convener of the Hunter Rural Multicultural Network and participates in the Singleton, Lake Macquarie and Tomaree Interagency Meetings. The SGP has participated in 15 planning meetings for community events which allowed her to continue to develop and expand her knowledge of community services, local government, and also with major services like Hunter New England Multicultural Health, and Centrelink.





New England Settlement Grants Program - Armidale

Judith Roberts

Funded by
Department of Social Services

The Armidale, New England Settlement Grants Program provides settlement information, referrals to government departments and community agencies, service planning, community capacity building to new arrivals, including migrants and humanitarian entrants, and the dependants of skilled migrants for all these groups up to 5 years of arrival. Humanitarian entrants face multiple barriers to settlement and high levels of socio-economic disadvantage. The client groups most represented are humanitarian entrants who are single parents with large families and single men. A number of issues relate to access to Citizenship, access to education, migration advice, legal access, victim's compensation in liaison with legal aid, AMEP, access to health services, housing, employment, money management or financial counsellors, and child care. Over the past year there has been a strong focus on migration enquiries leading to more referrals for migration advice. Many of these queries reflect the current international situation.

Table 1 Client Statistics

Type	Number
OSCAR 1 – Registration	20
OSCAR 2 – Casework	955
OSCAR 3 – Non casework	8574
OSCAR 4 – Group session	157

Client Services

Overall client issues identified, family relationships, access to mental health support, Centrelink, employment, transport, debt issues, health access, and homework support, access to childcare and to suitable English classes. The main client group of this service have been Humanitarian 202 visa holders with the next group being migrants on spouse visas. Many of the women face the added challenges as sole parents due to their husband's return to the country of origin, death, or family breakdown. Many young men are also quite a disadvantaged group whose main issues include employment, housing, and access to education and training. Employment opportunities are fairly stable with many continuing to work in industries such as the Guyra Tomato Farm, Aged Care, security work and contract cleaning. NSS works with Job Networks and Centrelink to support client's employment, childcare and education needs. Another area of employment has been childcare which has proven to be a good starting point for employment. NSS supports the attendance of our target group at AMEP and LLNP classes at TAFE. Many of our target group have been supported into stable accommodation through private rentals, or through public and community housing. Homes North Community Housing has been very responsive to the housing needs of new arrivals. There are a number of new arrival students who are at the University of New England and the TAFE across a range of disciplines.

A significant trend in the Armidale community has been a relatively high birth rate among new arrivals. Referrals to family support services have been an important resource to support family's needs. Working with these families has created an

opportunity for NSS to continue its collaboration with HNEH to support clients' health needs. Child care and access to specialised and general health has been an ongoing need. Some clients have had significant health issues; however, their needs are met well by mainstream health services. Clients travelling to Sydney have been supported with travel and accommodation arrangements. Many families have also moved on to having a car and driver which has made a huge difference to self-sufficiency and determination. Clients who have moved onto the Citizenship stage of settlement are extremely proud of their new country Australia. NSS Armidale has been able to support the work of STARTTS. The commitment made to the mental wellbeing of the Refugee community by STARTTS with the cooperation of the Settlement Service is making a real difference to the quality of settler's lives and is providing a caring settlement to new and longer term arrivals. NSS has also been in collaboration with the Armidale Women's Shelter and Hunter New England Health to facilitate a CALD Women's Support Group. The Armidale Women's Centre, NSS and Hunter New England Health are also collaborating to offer a Women's Cultural Café and Conversation Group will be held each month. NSS Armidale also works closely with the region's Multicultural Health Nurse and in all ways ensures that the health needs of our target group are supported. Outreach was made by Settlement Service to Inverell and Moree.

Refugee and ESL Homework Support

The Drummond Memorial School Homework Support has grown again this year with numbers of students and volunteers increasing. Held on Tuesdays and Wednesdays Mrs Fay Paris is the coordinator and produces an end of Term Report throughout the year. NSS is now auspicing the programs with the support of Department of Education and Communities, Armidale Sanctuary, Armidale Dumaresq Council. The program relies on volunteers from the community with many sourced through the Armidale Volunteer Referral Service. Students from Migrant and Refugee families who attend the program are tutored one to one with their school home work. Activities have also included Plan It Youth events and visits to a bakery and the University of New England. Students who have attended the program have improved in their school work and many have gone on to win scholarships at prestigious schools through academic and sporting talent".

Meetings and Committee representation

The SGP is involved in a broad range of networks some of these include the NE Multicultural Interagency Meeting which for the first time was held in Moree in May. The meeting was hosted by the Moree Plains Shire Council. Other meetings attended are the NE Multicultural Health Access Committee, Armidale Interagency, Domestic Violence Steering Committee and Sanctuary Armidale.

Events

In March the Vavina Mai Women's Group attended a Harmony Morning Tea hosted by Armidale Family Day-care this event strengthened the links between the women and extended their knowledge of services and facilities offered at Armidale Family Day Care. Events supported included the Youth Expo, the FCSS holding in Armidale Family Day Care Information session for the African Community, employment pathways with Australian Business Apprenticeships Centre. Finally, multiple achievements have been made across a range of areas for the Settlement Services target group. Individuals and families strive to make the most of their new lives and are moving toward independent lives as new arrival migrant and former refugees-congratulations to all.



New England Settlement Grants Program - Tamworth

Amalin Sundaravej

Funded by
Department of Social Services

The Tamworth base of the New England and the Hunter Settlement Rural Service Delivery Program (SGP) provides support services to highly disadvantaged new arrival refugees, family and other permanent resident visa holders who have low English language proficiency. Clients experience hardship through isolation, domestic violence, homelessness, mental health and other issues.

The Tamworth work addresses the lack of supportive networks by linking newly arrived migrants to their ethnic groups as well as to the Tamworth International Support Network (TISN) which comprises a multicultural group of new migrants whom NSS has developed and provides support services. In addition, NSS is assisting the refugee and migrant community's development and promoting a sense of self identity, belonging and participation with the broader Tamworth community. It also raises awareness among the mainstream service providers to assist them to become more responsive to needs of the target group in the Tamworth area.

During the reporting period, NSS Tamworth has undertaken outreach to identify client groups and to establish contacts/networks in Werris Creek and Quirindi under the Liverpool Plains Shire. This initial outreach approached the public libraries, the Salvation Army and the churches in these areas. More outreach is planned in the near future.

Overview of 2013-2014

Table 1: Client Contact & Project Work: 2013-2014

New Clients	Client Contacts	Telephone Calls and Emails	Group Work/Info Session
44	178	2743	3

Table 2: New Clients by Country of Origin

Clients	Number	Clients	Number
Sudan	2	Pakistan	1
Vietnam	4	UK	1
Philippines	9	Myanmar	5
Thailand	2	NZ	2
India	4	Ukraine	1
Fiji	2	Srilanka	4
China	2	Bangladesh	1
Bangladesh	1	Somalia	1
South Africa	1	South Africa	1
		TOTAL	44

Client services included providing assistance with Australian citizenship applications, housing, employment, health, education, family relationship issues, parenting issues, domestic violence, legal issues, overseas skills recognition, migration issues, access to interpreter services.

Referrals were made to DIAC, NSS Migration Agents, Jobs Australia, Skilled Employment, Baiada Agro Processing (factory), Country Fresh (lamb abattoir), Teys Australia (beef abattoir); Bindaree Beef (Inverell); Red Lea Chickens (egg picking/packing), Tamworth Community Centre (Volunteer Program), Medicare, Law Access (free call legal advice), Legal Aid, Chandler and MacLeod Employment, Tamworth Regional Council, MP Kevin Anderson (Small Business Connect); TAFE, UNE, Tamworth Public Library, among many others.

Referrals to NSS Tamworth 'SOS calls' from different organisations such as the Hunter New England Health (Community Services) with request of their migrant clients needing either help or support from their ethnic communities continues. Tamworth Multicultural Incorporated, a newly formed migrant network, made several referrals to NSS for all kinds of settlement support ranging, i.e. access to interpreters to long term accommodation assistance, etc.

Employment opportunities In Tamworth, employment opportunities for our new migrants and refugees target group, both skilled and semi-skilled, continue to find employment in the abattoirs and chicken agro processing plants which are the major sources of employment. Some find work in the beef abattoir in Inverell and recently, at the Gunnedah leather tanning factory. Various reasons hinder their employment such as overseas skills not being recognized in Australia not to mention the fact that the skills assessment process in itself is quite expensive and lengthy. Other factors include the absence of local work experience, fluency in English language communication, understanding Australian work culture. Business people I've spoken to mentioned that because most businesses in Tamworth are in the medium to small scale, they said they "cannot afford to do mentoring or do intensive supervision" because it is costly for their operations. The meatworks continues to attract African (male) communities to Tamworth as well as Burmese people from humanitarian background. Lately, competition for these jobs are coming from the mostly Asian (i.e. Korean and Taiwanese) holders of 'work holiday visas'. The main health complaint heard is "Repetitive Injury" caused by hard and routine work at the abattoirs. Smoking is also very much evident to "combat the cold" workplace as heard from many abattoir workers. Other migrant communities and especially Filipino women continue to be employed in chicken hatchery plants, egg picking and packing. A few younger women have gone on to obtain TAFE certificates in aged care which seems to be the preferred field at present.

Networking The SGP contacts and networks have helped in referrals and or job placements. Informal contacts with former migrants who are now gainfully employed continue to be a source of information for job openings. As well, migrants who are operating businesses (e.g., restaurants, petrol station, motels) ring NSS SGP for unemployed new migrants wanting casual or part-time work. Migrants helping new migrants are thriving and a big help and support which could be counted as part of this network. Expanding contacts with local business sector is also continuing as well as informal channels of employment opportunities are also made (i.e., casual work in farms and in small trades in Tamworth). NSS Tamworth, being the only NGO to provide support services for new migrants and refugees in Tamworth, is uniquely positioned and has been actively promoting issues and awareness on multicultural issues. Continued active networking with members of the New England Multicultural Interagency continues.

As well, the newly formed Multicultural Tamworth Incorporated, a community based organisation, is poised to assist and collaborate with NSS in its work with the multicultural groups in Tamworth.

Major Highlight of Events Harmony Day held at TAFE and the cultural diversity exhibition at the Tamworth Regional Gallery provided a picture of growing multiculturalism in Tamworth. State MP Kevin Anderson, in his welcome speech, at the opening night of the Tamworth Gallery exhibition said "I certainly believe that multiculturalism enriches us and we need to embrace it more"



Harmony Day at TAFE with AMEP students – "World On a Plate" was the theme at this event where AMEP students prepared delicious dishes from their countries and shared these with everybody including the students next door. On the same occasion, information was held about "Understanding Your Australian Spouse" and "Communication Issues in a Bicultural Relationship" by yours truly.





Refugee Settlement Grants Project Service



Emilie Wiggers, Lydia Manusiu, Kwabo Batande and Marie Zawadi

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

The Refugee Communities Settlement Grants Project (SGP) aims to increase independence, knowledge and ability for humanitarian entrants and new arrivals to navigate and access mainstream services and promote self-reliance in the Newcastle SSD. Eligible clients who have resided in Australia for less than 5 years are supported in their settlement by casework, information and referrals, advocacy, information sessions, promotion, settlement support groups, networking and mentoring.

Casework July 2013– June 2014

From July 2013 to June 2014 there were 127 clients registered under the settlement grants program and there were 911 instances of casework. Most service users came from Afghanistan, Iran, Iraq, Congo, Burundi, Ethiopia, Eritrea, Rwanda, South Sudan and Somalia. Our new clients were largely of Afghan background. Per month an average of 20 new and continuous clients were engaged in the program. A total of 6,366 incoming and outgoing contact occurred with clients and services. During this period 201 visa holders have commenced settling into the LGA. As primary visa holders were former interpreters for the Australian Army back in Afghanistan their English skills allow them to reach out to many supports and mainstream services in a much timely manner. Also with the implementation of the National Disability Insurance Agency in the local area 5 clients with disabilities were engaged/continued to engage with Multicultural Disability and Advocacy Service, Vision Australia, NDIS and Centrelink and they are now receiving holistic and highly beneficial support.

Main Issues:

Financial difficulty continues to trouble our clients. They experienced difficulty understanding Centrelink requirements and attending appointments due to layers of daily pressures. Budgeting is something they are continuously working towards however still finding it hard to manage all incoming bills namely utilities. We worked closely with St Vincent De Paul (SVDP) and NSS to provide EAPA Vouchers. SVDP assisted with budget counselling for 40 clients. SVDP also provided invaluable assistance to clients for food vouchers, furniture and clothing as well as winter items. Additionally providing financial assistance was accessed for children to attend school camps, and school resources. Accessing public housing and maintaining private rental accommodation is difficult for our clients.

A problem finding appropriate accommodation at affordable costs for large families on Centrelink payments is the primary concern for most clients. Many families are assisted in relocating to the outskirts of the Newcastle Local Area to accommodate with the surge of rental costs. Ensuring services utilise interpreting services and allow enough time to talk directly with our clients is a main advocacy role of the SGP service.

Many clients were referred to Hunter Tenants Advice and Advocacy Service for support. SGP has been assisting families with repairing or replacing their furniture received under the HSS provider "furniture package". In particular, 866 visa holders who do not meet the requirements to access these packages need intensive support to find furniture and other necessary equipment. As a result many referrals were made to welfare agencies for assistance.

Referrals:

Formal and informal referrals and contacts are made internally and externally. Within the 12 months of July 2013 – June 2014, these totalled 4686. Referrals have been received from a range of organisations and service providers. Most notable referrals have been internal referrals made to the youth worker, volunteering coordinators and the EIPP team, Complex Case, NSS Multicultural Playgroups, Mom's group, NSS social group at Adventist Church Hall, also numerous referrals made to Department of Human Services – Centrelink, Real Estates agencies and NSW Department of Housing NSW, EAPA, NSW Legal Aid, Hunter Community Legal Centre, STARTTS, Roads and Traffic Authority, NDIS, Interrelate, Family Planning, New Horizons, Penola House, Department of Education and Training, Many Rivers, Hunter Tenants Advice & Advocacy Service, Manning Valley Neighbourhood Service, Job Service Agencies, Multicultural Disability & Advocacy Service, Vision Australia, Out of Home Care Service Providers, St Vincent De Paul, TAFE NSW multicultural services, Mission Australia, Settlement Services International, Benevolent Society, NSW Police, Multicultural Liaison Officer NSW Police, Family and Community Services NSW and out-of-area SGP Providers and Migrant Resource Centres

The Refugee SGP project workers attended a number of formal Management Training during the year which enabled the workers to deliver more relevant services to the client group: AFL Multicultural Program – Afternoon Kick-Around with the Sydney Swans, AFL Community Ambassador Induction in Sydney, AFL Gala Day in Broadmeadow, AFL Multicultural Round in Sydney

- STARTTS Computer Classes, TAFE Tighes Hill, NSS & STARTTS
- AFL Grand Final Breakfast, Number One Oval, Newcastle, AFL & NSS
- Circle of Women, 'Who Cares, Why Bother' Event, Central Coast
- Parents Café at Islington PS
- Afghani Social Group at Islington PS
- Australian Red Cross Building Resilience Workshop, Cardiff
- Multicultural Interagency, NSS
- Refugee Network Meetings, NSS
- Refugee Council of Australia Consultation, NSS
- Multicultural Speakers Project, ECC
- Keep Them Safe Forums, Newcastle
- Harmony Day Committee, Newcastle & Lake Macquarie
- Bi-Lingual Workers Support Workshop, MNC
- Family Law Pathway Network Meetings, Newcastle
- University and Community Partnership Workshop, Callaghan
- Hamilton Public School Harmony Day Event
- Care and Protection Workshop, Gosford

- CRC Info Session, ECC
- NSS Parents Group, Thursdays, Seventh Day Adventist Church
- SGP Rural Conference, DIBP, Sydney
- Child Protection Training, Travelodge, DCS, Newcastle
- Case Management Training Part II, Travelodge, DCS, Newcastle
- Volunteer Week Morning Tea, NSS
- Healthy Eating Information Session, MNC
- Financial Literacy Information Sessions, NSS & DHS, TAFE Tighes Hill
- Multicultural Expo, MNC
- Hunter Community Legal Centre Workshop, HCLC, Newcastle
- Snow White Performance, Hunter Theatre Performing Arts, Broadmeadow
- Refugee Council and NEDA forum teleconferencing, NSS
- Red Cross disaster preparedness focus group, Multicultural neighbourhood Centre
- Mental Health First Aid Training, Hamilton
- Rights of Humanitarian Visa Holders Information sessions, TAFE Tighes Hill
- Female Genital Mutilation Training, NSW Multicultural Health NSS
- Falling Through the Cracks forum, Newcastle



*Rights of Humanitarian Visa Holders
Information Session held at TAFE
Tighes Hill on 12th November 2013.*

The **Congolese Communities Settlement Grants Project workers** provide support services to the Congolese Community in its settlement in Newcastle. The activities of the Congolese Settlement grants workers have been wide ranging and included: housing, provision of general information, employment, education and training, sport and linking community members to migration assistance.

Casework services: 216

Case work support was provided to all eligible people of this vulnerable group. The issues were many as with all refugee communities. Major events such as deaths and marriages have an enormous impact on the community demanding much support from the workers. Other issues affecting the community included:

- Housing and accommodation, cleaning, referring clients and tenancy advice
- Bill payments - providing information to our clients, explaining to them how to use home phone and internet to avoid a large payments.
- Employment - providing information on Job Network providers
- Learning to drive and gaining licenses.

Support and Assistance for the Newcastle Congolese Community

The Congolese Community has held regular meetings at NSS. During the year the Congolese community organised two general meetings that were supported by the NSS workers. This was an opportunity for the community to come together and to learn more about Australia. Work with the community included:

- Supporting them to participate in different events in the Hunter Region.
- Consulting with community leaders about how the community can be involved in Australian multicultural activities.
- Organising the Newcastle Congolese Community (NCC) election
- Organising information sessions with The Smith Family Saver Plus program
- Organising tenancy training and information sessions with different Real Estate Agents about property maintenance.
- The formation of a Congolese women's group, and children's group.
- Assisting the newly elected Congolese Executive with good governance training.

Working with young people

- Helped Young people of the Congolese Community to organise a formal traditional dance group to participate at various events during the year including Harmony Day, Australia Day and Refugee Week.
- Youth are supported to join other sporting groups e.g. Simba Soccer Club, Grainery Soccer Club: where they mix with Australian youth.
- We prepare young people to have a solid foundation, to become good examples for their community, and to prepare them for doing good deeds when they become adults.

We would like to thank our colleagues and management for their continued support and encouragement. We would further like to show appreciation for working with our clients who while challenging us still make us laugh.



Multicultural Youth Project

Tonkoh Kamara

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

The youth project's objective is to identify and address issues faced by young people from migrant and humanitarian background aged 12 to 25 years within the Newcastle LGA, with outreach to Maitland, Lake Macquarie and beyond when necessary. The project aims to increase young peoples' engagement and participation in programs and projects which will lead to increase in accessing services, and to develop their responses in filling in gaps in youth services provision, especially to new, small and emerging communities.

The main role of the youth worker in this project is the provision of support through information, referral, casework, advocacy, mentoring, service planning and development and capacity building through participation in socially inclusive educational and community programs to help youth from humanitarian and migrant background in their settlement needs. That is why the youth project worker has been participating in local and regional youth events, forums, conferences and community networks.

With regards to Casework Information and Referrals, the youth project had eighty (80) instances of casework mainly dealing with credit and finance agencies, correctional services (Long bay & Cessnock), Education pathways such RTO's, TAFE, community colleges and the homework support centres, youth accommodation and housing search inspections assistance, employment induction support, Centrelink regarding youth allowance and education benefits and dealing with sporting clubs and other social participations.

The project made 384 referrals mainly to; employment or job service providers, Accommodation with private providers and the Department of Housing where the youth worker provided support letters. Referrals were also made to schools, colleges, TAFE and employment training groups including charity organisations for assistance with materials. Young people were also referred to sporting and social clubs and organisations, Centrelink for youth allowance and other payments.

Over this reporting period the youth worker has outreached to schools with large numbers of young people from humanitarian and migrant background students, and as a result did twenty four (24) one-on-one mentoring of young people in the following high schools; Jesmond Callaghan Senior Campus, Wallsend Callaghan Campus, students from Waratah technology campus, San Clemente Catholic High school Mayfield, St. Francis Xavier Catholic High School, Hamilton.

The project conducted two group mentoring programs called "CALD Youth Life Skills Mentoring Program" at Newcastle High school during March 2014 which attracted between 16-22 participants, and at Wallsend Callaghan campus with between 14 – 16 participants. Issues addressed during the mentoring sessions include; team work, leadership skills, discipline, law and order, time management skills, the use of

public spaces by youth, rights and responsibilities, racism, bullying and cultural diversity in Australia.

The youth project was promoted at the different homework centres, the Africa day celebration activities, the combined youth interagency on 19th June 2014, the Regional Youth Development Officers Network conference on 23rd and 24th June 2014, The Hunter TAFE Certificate II in Community Services, to second year H & PE students at Newcastle University, the Police Multicultural Consultative Committee meeting at PCYC, schools and services, mini expo at Glendale High on 25th June and the Newcastle Central Coast Multicultural Interagencies.

The youth project worker has also developed and supported the delivery of a range of sporting, recreational and community activities for young migrants and humanitarian entrants. Sports and social participation programs such as; the multicultural youth soccer team (Hunter Simba FC), Culture Jam in partnership with the MNC, the school based drama project partly funded by NSS at San Clemente Catholic High school and the holiday indoor soccer matches are a great method of encouraging youth participation to integrate into Australian life, improving self-confidence and developing life skills.

The youth project supports developing communities and we are working with the South Sudanese youth in building their capacity in the areas of social participation, sports and arts. Ongoing information dissemination to CALD young people creating awareness regarding Hunter homeless connect day and what it means. The youth worker contributed to the formation of a young women's group in Newcastle. This group includes young women from various CALD background such as; Liberia, Sierra Leone, Burkina Fasso, Ivory Coast, Nigeria, Guinea, Ghana and Cameroon.

Sudanese	43 %	Congolese	39 %
Liberian	4 %	Mauritanian	3 %
Burundian	2 %	Afghanis	2 %
Rwandese	1 %	Ethiopian	1 %
Iraqi	1 %	Sierra Leone	1 %
Eritrea	0.5 %	Others	2.5 %

The number of Congolese has increased to thirty nine percent (39%) compared to 30% last year, due largely to good networking relationship with schools in the mentorship programs and community service providers.

In conclusion, this project has been able to assist with the development of strategies to support youth engagement, participation and to encourage these young people to have self-esteem and confidence in accessing services for their benefit. This project has supported young people from humanitarian and migrant communities in a range of social activities enabling them to better integrate into Australian life.



Volunteer Coordination Program

Michael Freund (Educational Programs)



**Funded by
Department of Social Services and ClubsNSW**

Educational Programs: Michael Freund

Welfare Programs: Emilie Wiggers

Volunteer Co-ordination Overview

The purpose of these positions is to co-ordinate assistance for NSS refugee and migrant SGP clients, from people in the wider Newcastle community, through a range of Educational and Welfare volunteering programs. Work is generated by individual requests for volunteer assistance received from clients or staff, and by the volunteer requirements of our managed programs. This focus drives the process of promotion, recruitment, and registration of suitable volunteers to fill those requests and program vacancies. Volunteer-client placement meetings and program inductions are organised to provide further information about the specific activities of volunteer roles. Ongoing guidance, support and training is offered to all NSS volunteers, e.g. caseworker support, ESL resources and feedback from teachers, Work Health & Safety training.

Volunteer Promotion & Recruitment -Strategic recruitment of new volunteers this year was again critical to the success of all volunteering programs. This was facilitated by promoting our volunteering vacancies on the NSS Volunteers webpage and email list, and via University of Newcastle services: iLEAD, Teach Outreach, Careers Service, Volunteering Expo; Hunter Volunteer Centre. 'Word of mouth' referral by current volunteers also increased as a source of recruitment this year. 20 mail-outs were sent to our volunteers email list to advertise current vacancies, congratulate and thank volunteers, and promote events. NSS began using its new Facebook page for these purposes as well.

Volunteer Induction & Registration

Each new volunteer was given a thorough and intensive induction on NSS, our volunteering programs, and general background information of our clients. Included this year is the compulsory Working With Children Check system requiring volunteers to provide their WWC Number to NSS for verification online.

Table 1: Volunteer Activity Statistics for 2013-14

Volunteer Category	Educational Volunteers	Welfare Volunteers
Enquiries Received	149	112
Registered	57	22
Re-started or Extended	19	13
Placed in Program	76	20
Inactive or Withdrew	81	31

As at 30 June 2014, approximately 115 registered volunteers were actively working in our volunteering programs. Note many more enquiries were again received this year than were able to be processed into registered volunteers and placed into a program with ongoing co-ordination and support. Some enquiries went onto waiting lists, while others were referred onto various other refugee & migrant services in the area, such as: Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre, TAFE Home Tutoring, and Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre.

Homework Centres (HWC): Around 100 volunteers participated

The HWC project has been funded since 2009 under the Settlement Grants Program, with annual donations received each year from Club GRANTS. This year funds donated by Wests Club, which assisted NSS run a fourth HWC. Throughout 2013-14 the project operated extremely successfully at our four partner schools: Hamilton Public School; St. Pius X High School; San Clemente High School; Waratah Technology Campus. HWC was managed by Michael Freund, and supported by a dedicated and hardworking team of NSS Homework Co-ordinators who brought considerable experience to each centre: Stephanie Couch (Hamilton); Bridie Scott (Hamilton Assistant); Josephine O'Hara (St. Pius); Cassie Galliot (San Clemente); Emilie Wiggers (Waratah).

HWC received around 65 student referrals from ESL teachers. With weekly average attendances were 53.5 students and 48.8 volunteers – our highest ever numbers! The majority of students were refugees from: South Sudan, D.R.Congo, Ethiopia, Mauritania, as well as a growing number from Afghanistan. There were also migrant students from: Tanzania, India, Tibet, Nepal, Philippines, Tonga, Iran, and Ukraine. Students received weekly one-to-one or small group volunteer support with English literacy & reading practice, homework, assignments, etc. These students would not have been able to receive this kind of regular assistance at home due to the limited English skills and time constraints of their parents or carers.



Harmony Day week in March was a great success at HWC this year. There was: multicultural food brought in by parents and volunteers, prepared speeches from students about their new life in Australia, students teaching volunteers some words from other languages, and more. This was a great way for students & volunteers to get to know each other better, thus promoting HWC as a team effort, as well as increasing social inclusion and celebrating the many positives of multicultural Australia.



Parental participation in HWC was also facilitated by: a registration day in Term 1, invitations to end-of-term parties, and rostered half-yearly parent interviews.

During the interviews, HWC staff, volunteers and ESL teachers had the opportunity to meet with parents in a welcoming environment, to provide encouraging feedback about their child's progress and to explain any learning concerns and how these might be addressed. Telephone interpreters or bilingual aides were used if required. A total of 13 parents attended interviews this year, representing 23 students enrolled in HWC.



Farewell to St. Pius Homework Centre (2009-14)

Our Homework Centre at St. Pius X High School, Adamstown was brought to a close at the end of Term 2, after running for five successful years. The closure was due to insufficient students enrolling for Terms 3 & 4. We sincerely thank ESL Teacher Carmel Martin for her dedication to the education of her students and for her constant support and assistance with our HWC program throughout the entire successful partnership. Ms. Martin, the two NSS Co-ordinators (Georgina Ramsay, 2009-2011 and Josephine O'Hara, 2011-2014) and the many volunteers who contributed to St. Pius Homework Centre over this time can all be extremely proud of its achievements, as we know that many students will continue to benefit from attending the centre, as they progress through their school years and beyond.

As a replacement for St Pius a new partnership has developed with Jesmond Public School where there is a high enrolment of children from Afghani and other refugee families. This new HWC will commence in term 3 2014.

In summary, HWC continued its important contribution to the education of recently-arrived refugee & migrant students in the Newcastle area. High School principals visited HWC each term to present our Student of the Term awards, and to thank staff & volunteers for providing the service for their students. ESL teachers reported many benefits of HWC for their students, especially in understanding the importance of regular homework and study to reinforce learning begun in class. These benefits extended not only to greater participation and improved results for students within the classroom, but also to greater confidence and participation in other school activities and in the broader community.

In-Home & In-School Tutoring: 10 volunteers participated

Volunteers provided weekly support with English literacy & reading practice, homework, assignments, for students one-on-one, in the client home or at a public library. Some volunteers also supported students with their learning in the school classroom. Students ranged from infants to primary to secondary school.

Adult Literacy/Citizenship Assistance: 56 volunteers participated -Volunteers in this program successfully delivered English literacy support to a variety of appreciative clients. This tutoring has increased our clients' independence and confidence, and has allowed them to be more successful in their educational endeavours and daily life. A few clients were also assisted in learning the requirements of the Citizenship program.

Parenting / English Group: 5 volunteers participated-Volunteers assisted at the Parenting / English group organised by Helen Buchanan, held on Thursdays at the Seventh Day Adventist Church in Hamilton. They provided a range of support, including assistance with child-minding, social interaction with families, and setting up the room and activities. One volunteer also started a **Men's Group**, working one-on-one with an Ethiopian man in woodwork and other handyman activities.



Driving Supervision: 4 volunteers participated-Volunteers provided support for clients to study for their Learner's licence test, and/or gain sufficient practice hours to apply for their Provisional licence/driving test. It takes a special volunteer to be willing to provide this service. It helps clients to become self-sufficient in a variety of ways, and benefits the rest of the family as well.

ESL Workshop: 14 volunteers participated- Volunteers participated in an ESL Workshop held in April, receiving guidance from an experienced ESL Teacher and NSS volunteer. The feedback was very positive with a repeat/follow-up session planned for later in the year.

Events & Festivals: 15 volunteers participated

Volunteers participated in various Harmony Day events around the Hunter area, the Multicultural Riverlights Festival at Maitland, and at NSS-operated and partnered playgroups.

**Conferences, Training, Networks, Interagencies, Events attended during the year.**

- SGP Rural Conference (DSS, Sydney)
- Understanding Youth Work for SGP Workers training (DSS, Sydney)
- Hunter Refugee Network Meetings
- Newcastle Multicultural Interagency Meetings
- NSS Staff Training Day
- Harmony Day events
- Newcastle Schools & Services Forum
- Professional Wellbeing Training (On The Line Training)
- Disaster Preparedness - NSS Focus Group (Aust. Red Cross)
- Setting Boundaries for Volunteers (HACC)
- Forced Marriage Seminar (Aust. Red Cross)
- RYDON Conference: Responding to Bullying and Cyber safety
- University of Newcastle: Vacation Work & Volunteering Expo



Settlement Grants Program- Settlement Services

Nellie Srisurapon – Central Coast Office

Funded by
Department of Social Services

This service provides assistance and information through casework, referrals, advocacy and group work to migrant and humanitarian community members, including youth, and their communities throughout the Central Coast. The service is available to eligible clients who have settled in Australia for 5 years or less. Due to the large area of service, over 1,850 sq. km, the program provides areas of outreach to safe, convenient locations where clients may have issues with transport, their safety and/or isolation.

Casework and Advocacy:

Migrants, especially those on family stream visas are showing a consistent rise in the region, especially in the last 12-18 months. The increase is not predominantly from a particular ethnic background, as was the case in previous years, but from cultures across the globe. The program is seeing more clients from Eastern Europe, Middle East, and Sth America as well as those from China and South East Asia. The main issues and challenges encountered are cases around Domestic and Family abuse, Employment, Transport, Family law and Income support. Language and the need to advocate for the use of interpreters was an ongoing issue, especially in the legal system, as were the challenges of insufficient refugee accommodation. The program also advocated for FREE bus travel for 4 clients going through hardship from Transport NSW which led to Transport NSW providing NSS with additional funding for transport for disadvantaged migrants on the Central Coast. Through an application to a local charity, we distributed 12 Xmas hampers to 12 clients and their families going through hardship.

- **278 face to face** contacts with the target group from **28 cultural backgrounds**, women from South East Asia and China are still the most to frequent the service
- **1213 instances** of service to support clients
- **8 Information sessions** to new arrivals about local support services

Referrals:

Predominantly word of mouth from the community, then Centrelink, Health and TAFE AMEP programs in both shires. Referrals have increased from the local Family Support Services and have also been made to the Thai, Chinese, African, Muslim, Korean, Greek, Filipino, Japanese, Russian and Spanish community for support. Regular emails were sent with information on education and training, activities and events, health issues, parenting/children among many other topics electronically to 110 community members. Internal referrals were also made to the Community Development Program, MSSS program, Volunteer program as well as the NSS migration agent.

- 936 formal and informal referrals were made. 4,854 instances of contact to target group / community were made electronically promoting a variety of information, training, activities and events.
- 9 clients were assisted with application to the Start Safely Program and 17 accessed Women's refuges and 21 referrals to Legal Aid.

Networking and Promotion :

The project continued a close relationship with many local services. Through the program NSS joined the Local Connections to Work Program to assist migrant clients at The Entrance Centrelink office. The worker is also active in the DV CALD committee, producing a brochure to raise awareness of DV to the target group. The program was involved in the 16 days (White Ribbon) committee and raised awareness of DV in the community. The committee also designed the White Ribbon Banner for the White Ribbon Walk.

Through the role as Convener for **the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency** relevant information was provided to its members by organising guest speakers (MYAN, Medicare Local, Ability Links) and sending out **4,580 instances** of relevant information electronically on topics such as: refugee and settlement news and reports, language resources and multicultural activities and events. Member participation at the Interagency has increased attracting over 20 representatives from various services.

The program was also promoted through:

- 11 Interagency meetings, 10 DV CALD/16 days meetings
- Cultural Competency training to 17 service providers
- CCMI Workshop on Using Interpreters to 19 Services and 42 target group
- 6 Agency visits plus NSS/SGP presentations at Health DV Forum, Wish Group, Thai Consulate.
- Training: Forced Marriage, Trafficking, Disaster, First Aid, Red Cross, Thru Black eyes. SGP Conference and DSS training , Fire safety
- Promoted NSS services at Harmony Day event, Day of Action, Chinese Festival, Refugee Week, White Ribbon walk and Taste of Harmony
- CCMI Multicultural Expo 2013 at Wyong - 46 services attended with 220 community visitors (on organizing committee – 9 meetings)
- Organized CALD community group on White Ribbon Walk 2013
- Attended Citizenship Ceremony at Gosford City Council
- Attended 3x16 days of Action stalls, raising awareness of DV in the community

This year I was honoured and humbled to be selected as one of three national finalists from 400 nominees in the Australian Multicultural Council **Caseworker of the Year** awards. Held at Parliament House I felt very proud to be representing NSS at the ceremony. Thanking all my colleagues for their support throughout the year and wishing NSS Staff and Board a Happy New Year in 2015



Multicultural Expo 2013



Citizenship Ceremony



Interpreter Workshop

Aged Care Services



Funded
by
Department of Social Services and NSW FACS



Multicultural Access Project Hunter (MAP)

Rasa Bajalis

Funded by

Commonwealth Home and Community Care Program (HACC) Department of Social Services (DSS) and NSW Department of Family and Community Services, Ageing, Disability and Home Care (ADHC)

The role of the regional MAP is to facilitate access of culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) communities to HACC and related services and programs, provide input into service development and planning and support services to develop culturally competent practices. The Multicultural Access Worker aims to assist with building capacity within Commonwealth Home and Community Care (HACC) Program to respond more effectively to the needs of culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) communities.

The project has spent considerable time this year consulting, collaborating, identifying and addressing challenges involved with the transition to the Department of Social Services and the changes in both the Aged and Disability Sector which has seen the roll out of the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) in Newcastle in 2013 and Lake Macquarie in 2014 - all of which have implications for CALD communities

Key actions undertaken and outcomes achieved in 2013/2014 include:

Consultation and Research

Following the release of the "Chinese Community Engagement Project" in November 2013, a successful application for funding was made to the HACC Funding Round to establish a Chinese Social Support Program which commenced in April 2014.

The CALD Dementia Working Party (which was formed as a recommendation of Cultural Diversity and Dementia in the Hunter and Central Coast research project 2011) has collaborated with regional Multicultural service providers and Alzheimer's Australia to facilitate information sessions on memory loss during Dementia Awareness Month in September 2014.

In addition the MAP worker actively participated in and /or raised CALD specific regional issues and unmet needs at the following consultations/forums:

- 2014 Community Planning and Information Sharing Workshop in July 2013 involved a review of past issues and strategies, as well as considering emerging concerns in the Muswellbrook Shire for CALD communities
- Community Sector Workshop for Ability Links "Developing a CALD Responsiveness Framework for Ability Links NSW" August 2013.
- NDIA Hunter Launch – ADHC and Service Providers Working Together Consultation October 2013

- Singleton Council's Strategic Planning Workshop January 2014
- "Key Directions for the Commonwealth Home Support Program" Discussion Paper with Department of Social Services (DSS) May 2014

Service Support, Training and Development

The MAP Hunter represented Northern Settlement Services at the following networks and interagencies:

Hunter CALD Aged & Disability Network (convened by MAP); HACC Issues Forum; MAP Network; Aged Persons, People with a Disability & Carers Forum in Maitland; Disability Network Hunter; Hunter Dementia Interagency; Hunter Rural Multicultural Network; Hunter Valley Community Care Forum; Singleton Community Care Forum; Port Stephens East Community Services Network; Upper Hunter HACC Forum; Hunter Central Coast Food Services Forum; Sector Support Forum for HACC Development Officers, Central Coast and Hunter MAP as well as convening the CALD Dementia Working Party and the CALD Disability Engagement group.

Service updates, information on professional development opportunities and current and emerging issues were distributed to these networks and interagency meetings across the Hunter. MAP also participated in the planning committees for Harmony Day, the Multicultural Expo and Refugee Week.

The Broadband for Seniors (BFS) Kiosk and Volunteer tutors continue to assist seniors with their computer skills. Classes are held Mondays for the Chinese community with a Cantonese speaking tutor. This class has up to 10 participants. The Tuesday class is a mixed cultural experience and varies from 2 to 6 participants.

In partnership with the MAP Central Coast delivered Cross Cultural Awareness (Organisational Perspectives) Training courses on August 2013 at Erina Fair on the Central Coast. In March 2014 the training was held at Beresfield in the Hunter.

Challenges

This year has embodied many and various industry briefings and workshops re departmental and industry changes across the Aged Care and the Disability Sectors. Even though it is "business as usual" for the MAP project until June 2015, there are many reporting matters to be managed and viable interface between service providers and CALD communities to be navigated. Projects and plans need to be completed and shared. The new service delivery models being introduced across the community care sector highlights the importance of providing culturally competent services and support to culturally and linguistically diverse clients and their families and carers at a time of major reforms.

As the Multicultural Access Project Worker for the Hunter I look forward to the remaining time to address these challenges and hope to contribute in a positive way to ease the transition of providing more flexible support options for clients and families.

I wish to thank everyone at Northern Settlement Services for their leadership, professional support and friendship. It is a privilege and a joy to belong to the Aged Care Team and be a part of the Northern Settlement Services.



Community Aged Care Packages

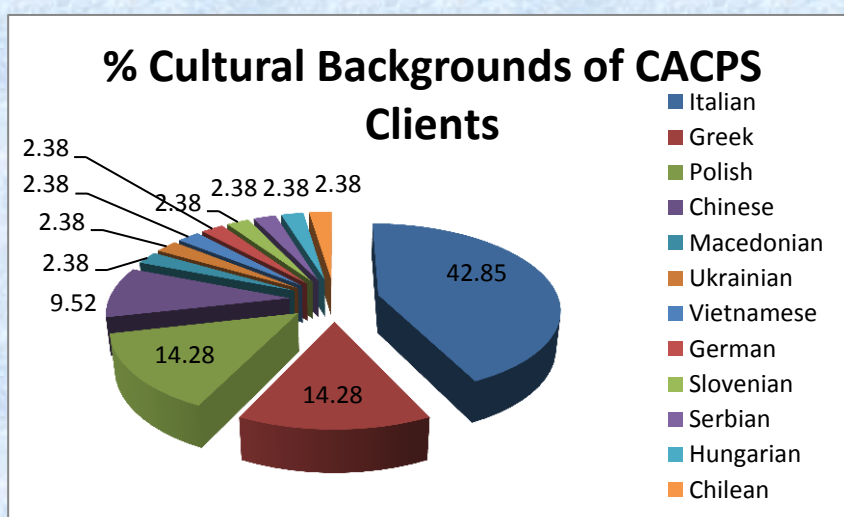
Sue Hristov, Lupe Fonua & Tima 'Oto

Funded by
Department of Social Services

The Community Aged Care Packages (CACP) program is in its 14th year of successful operation and continues to provide home based care and assistance to vulnerable, frail aged people who have complex care needs.

Our target group is older people from Culturally and Linguistically Diverse Backgrounds (CALD) in the Hunter region, who need assistance with the tasks of daily living to improve their quality of life and enable them to stay living independently at home as long as possible. We are currently funded to provide assistance to 42 people across the Hunter.

CARE RECIPIENT PROFILE - The current 42 Care recipients come from 12 different cultural backgrounds



Total of 42 care recipients:

- 35 female - 7 male
- age range from 71 to 96 years old
- 32 living alone
- 10 have a live in carer
- 6 have a diagnosis of dementia

Eleven clients exited packages during the year: 7 moved to residential facilities, 3 passed away and 1 moved to another provider due to higher care needs. The occupancy rate for packages was 96.60%.

LEVEL OF SERVICE PROVISION – as of June 2014 we provided 123 hours of direct assistance per week (down from 149 hours the previous year – due to a number of higher care clients exiting packages).

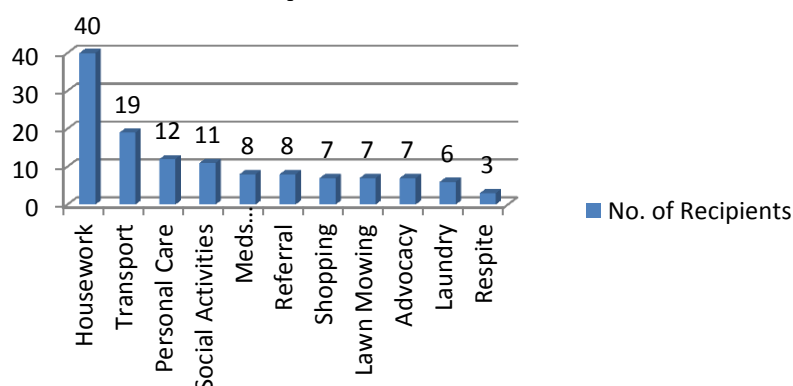
90% of our clients receive 5 hrs or less assistance per week- the average being 3 hrs (some require 1-2 hours per week and others with more complex care needs require significantly more- one client receives about 11 hrs).

MODEL OF SERVICE PROVISION

we continue to use the Brokerage Model for direct services as it has proven to be the most effective/efficient way of meeting the linguistic and cultural needs of our client group. The overall responsibility for Program Management/ Service Coordination rests with 3 Coordinators (on call 24 hours a day seven days a week) while direct service

provision (care workers who go to people's homes) is contracted from 5 reputable agencies.

No. of Recipients CACPS Services



CHALLENGES

- **Aged Care Reforms:**
 - the introduction of 4 levels of Home Care Packages
 - changes to fees – with the introduction of an income tested fee in addition to the basic fee
- **The Introduction of Consumer Directed care (CDC) next year** – upskilling Coordinators in preparation for CDC's has also been a major focus - we have also engaged a consultant to provide advice on appropriate financial management systems needed to provide clients with monthly individual budgets - a requirement of CDC
- We have applied for more packages in the last funding round (to be announced in December) - if we are successful we will need to offer them on a CDC basis from early next year. As well we will need to convert all our existing 42 packages to CDC's by 1st July 2015- and this will be the major challenge for the Coordinators and the Aged Care Manager, as well as for our existing clients, in the coming year

A busy and rewarding year for the CACP Project – many thanks to everyone at NSS, especially my fellow team members and the management and care workers from our brokerage agencies, for your continuing support. Receiving positive feedback from care recipients and their families and seeing the meaningful difference the program makes to people's wellbeing and their lives provides a great deal of job satisfaction despite its many challenges.



Hunter Multicultural Respite Service

Tima 'Oto – Co-ordinator

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

Hunter Multicultural Respite Service (HMRS) provides respite care for frail older people or people with dementia from non-English speaking backgrounds experiencing difficulty in attending Day Care Centres. The service aims to provide a culturally appropriate worker to assist with care of clients at the Day Care Centres to sustain their placement at Day Care and to provide their carers' with some respite.

The project also coordinates two support groups - the Multicultural Dementia & Disability Carers Support Group and the Vietnamese Friendship Group. Each group meets once a month at the Centre.

Model of Service Provision

HMRS is staffed by a part-time coordinator and direct care services are provided on a brokerage model, i.e. care workers are contracted from a number of local providers. The brokerage model has proven to be an efficient and effective model, as it enables the project to access a wider pool of workers and enables the service to better meet the cultural linguistic needs of particular clients.

Services provided

Throughout 2014 a total of up to 27 clients received weekly services of between 2-8 hours per week, including transport for 2 clients. Fifteen clients attend 2 days per week. Five new clients commenced services since the last report and 6 clients exited the service due to placement into permanent residential aged care facilities, others no longer needing respite and a few passed away. All clients have been formally assessed and reviewed 6 monthly. Every client referred to the service has been offered service after a short time or placed on the waiting list.

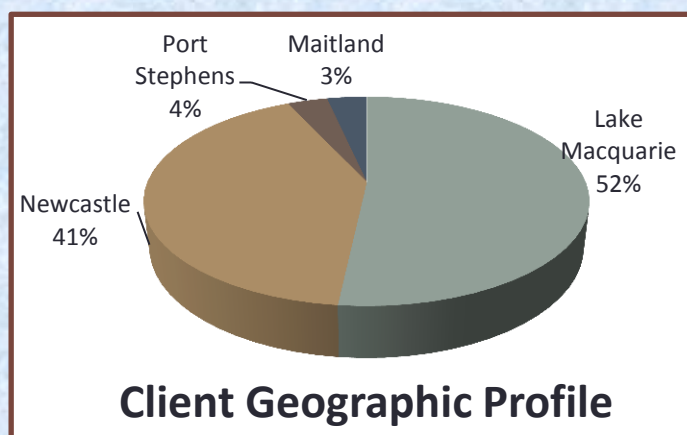
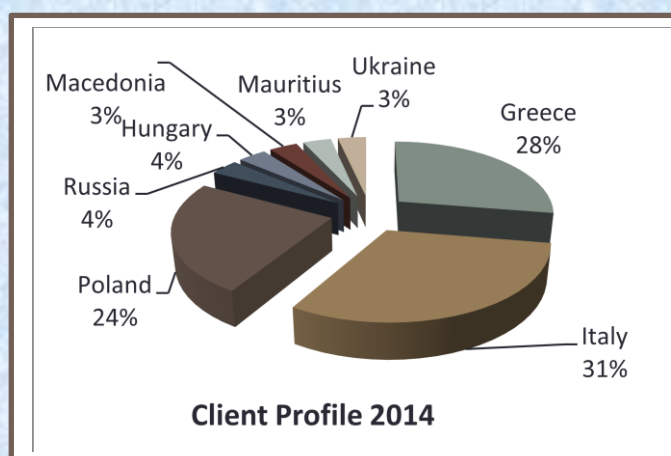
Table 1: Day Care Centres & Clients as at 30/6/2014

Day Care Centre	No of clients per Day Care Centres
Allawah Day Centre, Wallsend	1
Cardiff Multicultural Friendship Group	2
Greek Day Care	5 x 2 days
Greek Holy Apostles Day Care	3 x 2 days
Italian Day Care	7 x 2 days
Maitland Multicultural Friendship Group	1
Polish Day Care	7 x 2 days
Wattlegrove Day Care Centre	1
TOTAL	27 clients

The project also provided 8 hours a month to support up to 31 participants of the 2 groups, 19 Vietnamese and about 12 carers attending the Dementia and Disability Carers Group.

The majority of the clients live in the Lake Macquarie and Newcastle LGA's. A few clients are from Port Stephens, Upper Hunter and Maitland LGAs. 83 % are female and 17 % are male. The age ranges from 65 – 94 years of age and the average age of clients is 86 years of age.

Table 2: Client Characteristics of Day Care Centre clients								
Gender		Age					Client condition	
Male	Female	55-65	65-74	75-84	85-90	91+	Dementia	Frail Aged
7	20	0	2	5	17	3	4	20



Multicultural Dementia and Disability Carer Support Group

The service coordinates the monthly meeting of the support group with attendances of Hunter Area Health Worker, Dominique Nyalis who organises guest speakers and information sessions to assist and support carers: e.g. Tai Chi, Pelvic Floor Exercise/Continence Management, Organ Donation, Advanced Care Planning, Healthy Eating.

Vietnamese Friendship Group

The Vietnamese Friendship Group is enjoying their get together every month which allows them to socialize in a friendly atmosphere as well as to improve access to a range of support services in the Hunter, by having the opportunity to increase skills and knowledge through interesting guest speakers, activities and social outings such as bus trips and lunches. The group is run with the assistance of a Vietnamese interpreter sourced from Hunter Health. Guest speakers from Hunter Health have also provided information on Arthritis, Back Care, Diabetic, Advanced Care Planning, Falls Prevention, Mind Your Mind, Rights and Responsibilities. The highlight of the year is their annual shopping trip to Cabramatta which

enables them to shop and reminisce and enjoy the atmosphere with people from their own background. Most of the older people have smiles on their faces and say: "it feels like home".



Major changes in the past year

As part of the preparation for the introduction of the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) the funding for the project previously received from the Department of Ageing, Disability and Home Care (DADHC) was split

between Commonwealth HACC - 95% (for people over 65 years of age) and DADHC - 5% (for those under 65 - disability). This small portion of the funding was lost when the client transferred to NDIS.

Training/ meetings attended throughout the past year

Work Health and Safety and Child Abuse and Neglect (NSS & SSI), Red Cross Workshop – Building Resilience to Disasters for Vulnerable Communities, Networking with other service providers at the EXPO, – Learn about Disability Care in Australia, Goals and Enablement, Professional Wellness Training, The Enablement Approach in Community Care, MDS training, Consumer Directed Care in Diverse Communities, NSS Staff Training day, DADHC Meeting, CDC info, Expo at East Maitland, Aged Care Team Meetings.

I would like to thank the Board and my colleagues at NSS for their assistance and support, which has enabled the service to consolidate and build successfully throughout 2014.



Central Coast Multicultural Social Support Service

Anita Trainor, Kellie Matterson and Marilyn Perez Cabrera

Funded by

Commonwealth Home and Community Care Program (HACC) Department of Social Services (DSS) and NSW Department of Family and Community Services, Ageing, Disability and Home Care (ADHC)

The NSS Multicultural Social Support Service (MSSS) supports CALD people in Wyong and Gosford LGAs who are: frail aged, younger people with disability and their carers through matching them with Volunteers attached to MSSS. Support can include: home visits, telephone calls, taking clients to medical appointments, shopping, banking, etc. They also support them by providing them with access to social functions, outings and other events organized by the MSSS Coordinators. The Coordinators recruit, train and manage volunteers so that they can provide a quality and reliable service to the program clients from a CALD background. Up to date training is offered to volunteers up to four times a year and the Coordinators are available to supervise volunteers and advise them on issues that concern them.

CLIENTS

Over 100 clients, used the service during 2013-14. Unfortunately some clients have entered Aged Care Facilities mostly suffering dementia while others have passed away. Due to the diversity of backgrounds and the disparity of the geographical area, social isolation is a major factor to many of NSS clients. Across the Wyong and Gosford LGA's social groups have been formed at Bateau Bay, 3 sessions per month, Woy Woy and Kanwal meeting weekly. Activities across these groups include craft, sharing of multicultural food, celebration of special cultural events as well as outings. Presentations are given at least bi monthly on topics such as health management, dementia awareness, healthy ageing. During the last Financial Year most referrals to services offered by MSSS came from Central Coast Access Point, ACAT and Mental Health Unit as well.

VOLUNTEERS

There are 28 active volunteers and in order to show appreciation to this group of dedicated people, MSSS provides them with a special Christmas lunch, a special lunch during Volunteers' week, training opportunities including 4 training sessions that MSSS provides and other training which may be available through local organisations. Group discussions occur after the training sessions provided by MSSS. The training covered: Tai Chi, Enablement Skills Development training, Wellness training workshop and Grief & Loss training. Supervision is available for volunteers either on a one to one basis or as a group. The Team also issues a quarterly newsletter to volunteers which provide them with information about the service, such as Government changes, upcoming training, dates for payments of their expenses, upcoming event, etc.

STAFF TRAINING

- Wellness
- Enablement Approach Skills Development Workshop Levels
- Setting Boundaries for Volunteers
- Building Resilience for Disasters CALD Workshop
- Conflict Resolution
- Dementia workshop – Understanding and assessing behaviours
- Symposium for Dementia and Disabilities at Parliament House, Sydney
- Dementia Forum for Spanish Speaking Community

NSS/MSSS EVENTS

- Harmony Day Festival
- Volunteering Central Coast Expo
- Multicultural Expo, 24th October at Wyong Council The Goats' Festival
- Coast Community Connect Day at Central Coast Youth Club
- Wellness Expo at Kariong Community Centre
- White Ribbon Breakfast at Breakers, Wamberal
- White Ribbon Walk 2013 and NSS promotion stall at The Entrance Foreshore Park
- Australia's Biggest Morning Tea (Cancer Fundraiser) at Peninsula Community Centre, Woy Woy

The MSSS Team is very busy not only in the coordination of the groups and the organization and supervision of volunteers but also continuously participating at community events in order to promote the service and recruit volunteers. Training has been most beneficial to staff in areas of "Wellness".



Multicultural Expo



Chinese Social Support Project

Dongmei Zhang

Funded by
Department of Social Services

The Chinese Social Support Project (CSSP) aims to provide an appropriate social support program to frail older people from Chinese background who live in Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens and Maitland local government areas.

The focus in the initial stages of the project has been to organise group social activities. By the end of June, three social support groups were successfully set up at Wallsend (Newcastle), Charlestown (Lake Macquarie) and East Maitland (Maitland) - with participant numbers continually increasing. In the coming year the project will expand to also include recruiting volunteers for one to one social support.

HIGHLIGHTS

Activities for the 3 social groups have been organised to include information sessions from Department of Human Services – Multicultural Services Officer, Basic Skills for your Garden, How to look after your Vision from Royal Society for the Blind; and an introduction to the services at "The Place" at the Community Centre at Lake Macquarie. Planning for a Tai Chi exercise group to start after June was undertaken - to be facilitated by a volunteer at The Place. A dumpling lunch is also planned for both Newcastle and Maitland groups.

VOLUNTEERS

Recruiting volunteers is a big challenge to CSSP. Due to the language barrier, it is preferable that volunteers speak either Cantonese or Mandarin.

NETWORKING

Since the CSSP kicked off in April this year, a lot of effort was put in to promote the project at several events, such as Hunter Multicultural Expo and especially events organised by the Hunter Valley Chinese Association, such as the Dragon Boat Festival and the Senior's lunch get together in June. There was also networking with the Chinese Temple, Senior Bible Study group and the Tai Chi group to recruit both clients and volunteers.



I really appreciated Rasa, Alex, Lydia and Rose taking CSSP brochures to the networking meetings which they attended routinely.

A special thank you to Multicultural Social Support Services (MSSS) Team at the Central Coast. They generously shared not only MSSS documents, but also the experiences they accumulated in the past several years. A short visit to MSSS group and friendly chat with Kellie and Marilyn boosted my confidence to run a successful CSSP in Hunter.



Community Visitors Scheme

Enza Di Stefano

Funded by
Department of Social Services

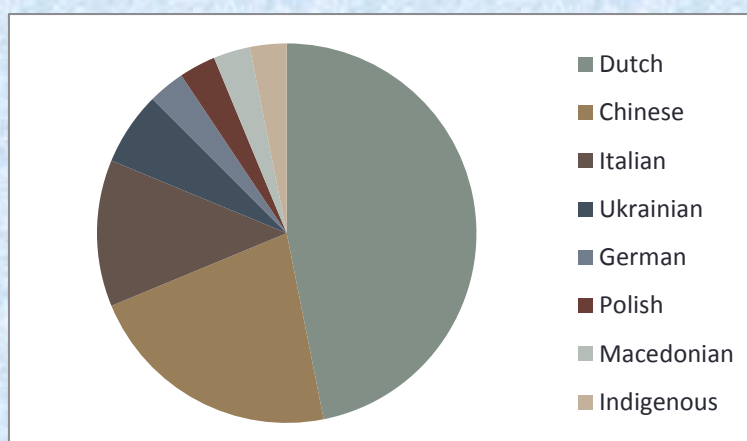
Introduction:

The NSS CVS continues to provide a highly effective program to residents of CALD background in the Lower Hunter Aged Care Facilities. Over the past 12 months 17 facilities have been visited with a total of 553 visits to 32 residents and 9,049 kilometres travelled. There has been much liaising with Aged care Facilities in this reporting period in order to match prospective CVS visitors to residents.

Community Visitor Recruitment and Turnover:

Recruitment is an on-going process and during the year 15 visitors were active. Due to the language / cultural background 3 volunteers visit more than one facility and 5 visitors visit more than one resident at the same facility. Three referrals from Aged Care Facilities have been received and been filled with current and new volunteers; two referrals of volunteers have been received from Hunter Volunteer Centre – both have been orientated and one resident match found. Two new volunteers have been recruited, orientated and successfully matched with residents. Sadly, two volunteers have resigned one due to ill health and the other due to caring duties for her elderly mother.

The 32 Residents' Cultural Background



Orientation / Support Activities:

Individual orientation took place for 3 new visitors including Police Checks. Renewal of Police Checks is undertaken as necessary. All visitors are regularly contacted - at least once a month - either by phone, email or mail to maintain communication and support.

A "Meet and Greet" Morning Tea was held to introduce the 3 new volunteers to 5 of the longstanding experienced CVS volunteers – it was a rewarding morning for all.

Special Events, Highlights, Good News Stories

A longstanding Dutch volunteer gave a presentation on Holland at a new facility he visits, with the facility asking that he present again in the near future. National Volunteer Week was celebrated with a lovely Morning Tea together with all of NSS's other volunteer programs. It was most successful with one of CVS's 86 year young volunteers speaking of her volunteer experiences. End of year celebration was an outing to the Hunter Valley Gardens, enjoying a tour of the beautiful flowers, shrubs, trees and a lovely lunch.

Networking:

Two Hunter Networking Meetings were conducted – 10th July and 5th December 2013 - opportunity to support each other in promoting the CVS. Two CVS Regional Network Meetings took place with most of the discussion being on the expansion of the CVS Program and the "Social Inclusion" policy of Government. Three auspices in the Hunter & Central Coast areas were successful in gaining expansion funding.

Benefits of the Scheme:

The principle benefit of the Scheme is that Visitors play an integral role in easing the social and cultural isolation. Matching resident with visitor who has similar cultural and language backgrounds is especially important to our target group as people often revert back to their mother tongue with advancing years and the onset of dementia. Having a visitor from a similar cultural background provides an opportunity for residents to maintain a link to the community. The benefits to the visitors are many - their feeling of being valued; their new friendship formed or strengthened over the years; the sense of community and the sense of wellbeing – both mentally and physically.

Great news for CVS as NSS was successful in receiving CVS extension funding – the Hunter and Central Coast will receive ten visitors each for clients who are in receipt of Commonwealth subsidised home care and the Central Coast will receive five 'group' visitors in 2014 -2015 and increasing to ten in 2015 -2016 in Aged Care Facilities.

This coordinator has tendered her resignation effective July 2014, to take on another role within the organisation. It has been a privilege to have coordinated this amazing program for over 7 years and to have worked with such a special group of volunteers whose compassion, caring and dedication is immeasurable. Thank you to present and past volunteers, the amazing Aged Care Team and NSS board members for their support and friendship in coordinating the CVS.



CVS Christmas Outing

Multicultural Family Support & Welfare



Funded
by
Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services



Multicultural Family Support & Welfare

Early Intervention & Placement Prevention (EIPP) Program

**Petrona Kelly (Team Manager), Juanita Purcell-Loli, Elena Ferguson,
Lydia Manusiu, Finau Manu**

**Funded by
NSW Department of Family & Community Services, Community Services**

The service operates in Newcastle, Lake Macquarie with outreach services provided to locations across the Lower Hunter as capacity allows at Maitland, Cessnock & Port Stephens.

The Early Intervention & Placement Prevention Program (EIPP) targets low to medium risk children, young people and families from Culturally and Linguistically Diverse Backgrounds for short term support to identified issues to prevent escalation of problems. The duration of the service is three months and can be extended a further three months upon review or to a year if the client is re-assessed as needing continuing service to achieve agreed goals.

This support service model is structured to deliver two streams of service provision:

- Child and Family Support targets families with children aged 0 – 12 years or expecting a child.
- Youth & Family Support targets young people 12 to under 18 years or families with young people in this age range.

The Welfare Team Service Activities Included the following:

- Advice & Referral by providing comprehensive information and advice to young people and families
- Assessment & Case Planning by providing assessment & case planning to assess the strengths & needs, including any risks; plan & coordinate a mix of services to meet the needs of clients
- Casework by undertaking activities to implement the case plans of individual clients: information & advice, support, advocacy, referrals to relevant agencies or specialist services, etc
- Home visits delivered to individual family home or another location
- Counselling by providing counselling to young people and/or families who have been assessed as needing counselling
- Practicals/Skills Development Groups by providing practical skills in a group situation
- Parenting Skills Group by providing structured parenting programs
- Parent Support Groups by facilitating self-help/peer support groups for parents

Likewise, the Welfare Team in partnership with other organizations is heavily involved in supporting multicultural playgroups at various locations in the region:

- MOMS (Mothers' Obstetrics Multicultural Support in partnership with Hunter New England Multicultural Health Services being run at Ethnic Communities Council (ECC) in Waratah
- Raymond Terrace Playgroup at Thou-Walla Family Centre in association with First Chance
- NSS Multicultural Parenting Group at Ethnic Communities Council (ECC) in Waratah
- Multicultural Supported Playgroup at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC) in Lambton working together with Kindergarten Union (KU), MNC & Mission Australia
- Multicultural Playgroup Lake Macquarie in collaboration with Lake Macquarie City Council & The Willows, being held at Uniting Church, Warners Bay
- NSS Parenting Group being run at the Seventh Day Adventist Church, Hamilton
- Woodrising Playgroup, a joint project between Wesley Mission and NSW Community Services at the Woodrising Neighbourhood Centre in Woodrising
- NSS Multicultural Playtime Group in partnership with Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC) held at the centre in Lambton

During the year, the Welfare Team provided approximately 2,720 instances of services to clients. Their issues are inter-related in many cases and on many occasions a client/family presented a number of needs/problems.

Issues/Problems Presented By Clients:

Issues/Problems	No of Instances	Issues/Problems	No of Instances
Domestic Violence	280	Legal Matters	215
Settlement Information/General Information	400	Immigration/Citizenship/Sponsorship/Passport Applications/Renewals	200
Health/Mental Health	85	Housing/ Accommodation	150
Youth Issues	105	Education & Training	120
Employment	48	Police Matters	27
Child Support	22	Family problem	268
Income Support/Financial Difficulties	110	Material Assistance (EAPA)	281
Childcare	45	Aged Care	45
Tax Help (ATO)	40	Others	279
		TOTAL	2,720

Other Issues/Problems/Needs:

Social/emotional, isolation, separation & divorce, death & bereavement, gambling, discrimination, harassment, neighbourhood disputes, tenancy disputes, document translation, language difficulties, supporting letters, transport difficulties, problem with real estates, travel infringements, form filling, court support, JP signature, access to belongings, cultural information, non-recognition of overseas qualifications, problems with in-laws, court support, assistance in running community events, etc.

Referrals Came from: Women's & Children's Refuges, John Hunter Hospital, Mater Hospital, schools, Family Referral, Centrelink, New England & Hunter Area Multicultural Health, youth accommodation, Community Services, legal services, solicitors, New England & Hunter Community Mental Health, Community Services, Housing NSW, community organizations, self-referrals, Domestic Violence Court Assistance Scheme, NSS Staffs, etc.

Clients Countries of Origin: Philippines, Thailand, Russia, Tonga, Samoa, Fiji, Afghanistan, Iraq, Iran, Sudan, Somalia, India, China, Japan, Spain, Vietnam, Nepal, Burundi, Sierra Leone, Indonesia, Macedonia, Nepal, South Africa, New Zealand, Hong Kong, Malaysia, Germany, France, Australia, etc.

Other Services Provided to Clients include:

- EAPA vouchers
- Assistance with gas and water bills
- Tax Help

Group Work: Welfare staff are also responsible for running parenting groups / information sessions either at NSS premises or at other locations including:

- Russian Bicultural Children's Group at Wallsend
- Samoan Women's Group at NSS
- Filipino Women's Group at NSS

Participation in Events:

- Lake Macquarie Harmony Day celebration at Warners Bay
- Hamilton Harmony Day celebration, Hamilton Primary School
- Singleton Harmony Day celebration, Singleton
- Cessnock Harmony Day celebration, Cessnock
- White Ribbon Breakfast, Panthers Newcastle – Pet Kelly, guest speaker, "Domestic Violence Among CALD & Refugee women in Newcastle"
- Child Protection Breakfast, New Lambton
- Multicultural Expo, Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre, Lambton
- Schools & Services Expo & Workshops, Glendale High School
- River Lights Multicultural Festival, Maitland
- Lake Macquarie Interagency meeting, Charlestown
- Quit Smoking Project, Hamilton
- Refugee Week celebration, Jesmond Park
- Lake Macquarie Family Exhibition, "You Are Kidding Me Expo"
- Lake Macquarie Disaster Focus Group, Natural Disaster Resilience Project

Staff Training:

- Department of Human Services Centrelink Multicultural Forum
- Legal Aid workshops (Immigration, Domestic Violence)
- Greater Newcastle Family Law Pathways Network Conference "Falling Through the Cracks"
- Female Genital Mutilation awareness
- Forced Marriage Information session
- Focus on Early Childhood Inclusion
- Multicultural Access Committee (Community Services)

- Communicating Effectively with Culturally Diverse Children & Families Training workshop "Engaging Young People from Multicultural & Refugee Background" training
- "Practical Skills in Responding to People who Experience Domestic Violence" training
- Think smart Multicultural conference
- Know Your Consumer Rights seminar
- Moving Forward Forum on Suicide prevention
- Zeni and Desie, our Brighter Futures Workers and members of the Welfare Team have completed the Triple P (Positive Parenting Program) training. The Welfare Team now have six Triple P Accredited Practitioners.

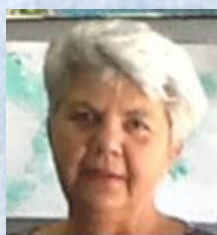
During the reporting period, I have supervised 2 Social Work students at different times on placement here at NSS both from Charles Sturt University who did 510 hours each. Both turned out to be good placements who worked as team members and independently as required. One had a face to face component doing casework with clients while the other had research. She did a very good job and developed an NSS Child Protection Policy.

Last year, part of the Philippines was hit by a powerful typhoon which killed thousands and devastated people's homes and livelihoods. The brainchild of the Reverend Stephen Williams, Dean of Newcastle Christ Church Cathedral, a Special Prayer Service for the victims was held at the Cathedral attended both by Filipinos and Australians alike. Likewise, in attendance were political and church leaders from other denominations. The donations were turned over to ABS- CBN Foundation, Inc. Lingkod Kapamilya (Family Services) one of the leading agencies helping in the rehabilitation of communities.

We also saw the Russian community through the leadership of Irena Lupish and Elena Ferguson organise a fundraising drive which was able to collect \$600.00 for the typhoon victims. Material things were also donated. A donation of \$178.10 also came from the Merewether Buchanan Retirement Village. The Greek community through Fr Nicolas (Greek Orthodox Church Holy Apostles) donated clothes, blankets, shoes, etc. as well. I would like to thank them all on behalf of the Filipino community

I am very pleased to report that in my capacity as a Social Worker and a member of the Australian Association of Social Workers (AASW), three women, two of them with 2 children each were granted permanent residency recently. I was one of the "competent persons" who was able to provide non-judicial evidence in relation to domestic violence situations for the Department of Immigration & Border Protection

Indeed, it has been a very hectic year for the team, but a satisfying one. It is a pleasure leading the Welfare Team for their continued hard work and cooperation and who create such a wonderful working environment. Warm thanks go to each and every one of them. On behalf of the Welfare Team, I would like to thank Lulu, the NSS Board of Management and colleagues for their continuing support and encouragement. Likewise, the Admin staff for their assistance.



Multicultural Family Support Project-Families First

Miza Torlakovic

Funded by
Families NSW

Project Description: The Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) specific Family Project under Families NSW provides support to vulnerable disadvantaged families comprising of first time parents and families with children aged 0-8 from CALD backgrounds. The target group includes teenage parents and parents with a developmental disability and/or parents with other special needs who live in the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie LGAs.

Table 1: Family types based on Families NSW Online Data Report, July 2013 to June 2014

Total Number of supported families	Young parents 25 years or less	Number of families finished the service	Number of children 0-8 years supported	Sole parents
99	17	62	164	18

Table 2: Families identified in specific groups

Rural/ Remote families	Disability /special needs families	Number of grand parents	Number of Individuals speaking other Languages	Number of referrals to other services
6	6	12	97	712

Service delivery

Tables 1 & 2 show the variations in family types supported by this project. During the year, the project provided much face to face casework for the client group from 27 diverse ethnic backgrounds. Face to Face casework including home and hospital visits to address a number of different issues such as: parenting practices, health and children's health, torture and trauma, child care, schooling issues, family/ domestic violence, legal issues, Centrelink, material/financial assistance, accommodation, immigration, learning English and social isolation.

During the year three families were referred and accepted to the Brighter Futures Program and four families attended /received Triple PPP (Positive Parenting Program) training in partnership with the Multicultural Health Unit Worker.

A number of referrals were made to Hunter Area Health, Child Care Services, Child and Family Health, Mental Health Services, Family Planning, police, HDVCAS, Tenancy Services, legal, housing services, social workers, community workers, TAFE and schools, children & women's refuges, Brighter Future Programs, legal services, NSS Migration Agent and NSS Volunteer programs.

Group and Individual Programs

MOMS (Mothers Obstetrics and Multicultural Support) Friendship group is a partnership with the Multicultural Health Services. The group aims to make the journey to motherhood easier and more enjoyable for CALD Mothers, through the provision of relevant education and social networking. During the year 12 Sessions were held on settling babies, kid safety, baby development, mental wellbeing/ post natal exercise, introducing baby food, child speech and language development. 195 people attended the group including: mums, children, babies and family members. Interpreters in Dari/Farsi, Thai, Vietnamese, Korean, Spanish and Mandarin languages were used.

Multicultural Parenting Group – Throughout the year 11 group activities for 150 CALD parents / carers and children in total were held at the Ethnic Communities Council (ECC) on a monthly basis.

This group provides Information and social support with topics based on parents' requests. These include: early child intervention, Positive Parenting Program (PPP), healthy eating, Community Languages School, child and mental health, child speech and language development, information on healthy relationship & Tree of Life.

Multicultural Kindergarten Union (KU) Supported Play Group – A partnership with KU, MNC, Mission Australia and Community Services saw 34 playgroup sessions held with 427 parents and children attending. The families attending also enjoyed sharing children's birthdays, bbqs picnics and library visits.

Woodrising Play group

Since last year, 9 sessions have been supported with 271 parents and children attending. As of February 2014 the NSS Welfare Team by request of Wesley Mission and NSW Community Services, has been supporting the playgroup on a weekly basis due to the high number of CALD families.

North Lake Macquarie Play Time Group

In February 2014, The Willows Uniting Church, Lake Macquarie City Council & NSS joined together to start a new Multicultural Playgroup, which provides a friendly and welcoming place for parents and carers from Culturally and Linguistically Diverse backgrounds. It aims to encourage and provide a playing environment in which children are able to play and make friends while their diversity is nurtured, respected and celebrated.

Activities for this group includes storytelling, music, singing, games and craft, as well as networking, support and resources for parents and carers.

There were 12 sessions with 61 parents and 63 children attending every 1st, 3rd & 5th Wednesday of the month at Warners Bay. First Chance is supporting the families in promoting children's learning and building social skills.

Community Capacity Building

- This project was also involved in coordinating a number of drug and alcohol consultations in partnership with Multicultural Health Services for emerging communities such as the Congolese, Burundi, Mauritanian, Ethiopian and Sudanese providing them the opportunity to express their views to the harm caused by drugs and alcohol to individuals and families and to identify their strengths in dealing with these issues. The sessions were held at NSS premises after office hours. Kirundi, Swahili and Dinka interpreters were used. As a result of these consultations an African Communities Draft Tool kit has been developed.

- Another major community event was the Lake Macquarie Harmony Day Celebration which was another joint event with members of the Newcastle Multicultural Interagency - a great success.
- Refugee Week Celebration – Family Picnic at Jesmond Park was attended by over 150 migrants and refugee background families. A variety of entertainment was enjoyed by the children and adults. In the evening, there was a viewing of the film “Mary Meets Mohammed”, at Birmingham Gardens with some 90 people attending. Delicious light refreshments were served prior to the viewing.
- The Multicultural Services Expo at the Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC) was another great event with around 200 people attending.

Meetings attended / Committee Memberships

The project strongly networks with a wide range of mainstream and community agencies to deliver the service and these include: Hunter New England Multicultural Service, John Hunter Hospital, Community Mental Health Services in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie, Housing NSW, Compass Housing, Women's & Children's Refuges, Nova Women's Housing, Family In Sight, Hunter Community Legal Centre, Hunter Women's Domestic Violence Court Advocacy Service, TAFE, Child Care Centres/ Play Schools, Hunter Multicultural Forum - Centrelink, churches and charitable organisations.

Interagency membership included: Lake Macquarie, Newcastle Migrant Interagency, Hunter Refugee support Network, Hunter Central Coast (HCC) Multicultural Advisory Committee (MAC) Community Services, Hunter New England's Mental Health Multicultural Access Committee, CDAT, Hunter Women's Domestic Violence Advocacy Service and Multicultural Advisory Health Committee.



Refugee Week 2014



Woodrising Playgroup



North Lake Macquarie
Multicultural Playtime Group



Community Builders - Community Development

including Playing around the World

Pari Batha / Natalia Meliendrez

Funded by

NSW Family and Community Services, and Benevolent Society and Gosford City Council

Pari Batha and Natalia Meliendrez

The two project workers represent and raise awareness about the Central Coast Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD) Community. Working closely with the CALD community, local community leaders, advocates, service providers and other relevant networks. The project supports the Central Coast CALD Community to participate in general events and facilitates opportunities for members of the CALD community to exchange their cultural experience with the wider Central Coast community.

Multicultural cooking classes: This program assists in connecting CALD communities with the mainstream community through teaching and sharing in the preparation and consumption of traditional dishes from different ethnic groups and communities. This is undertaken at multiple locations across the coast including; Green Point Community Centre, Kariong Neighborhood Centre, Warnervale Family and Community Centre and Gosford/ Narara Neighborhood Centre. The aforementioned centres have hosted a variety of cooking experiences from Chile, Greece, Brazil, Afghanistan, Iran, India, Philippines, Thailand and China. The sessions promote understanding and valuing of other cultures. Essentially they are an opportunity for attendees to learn about each other's cultural backgrounds, beliefs and way of life. They highlight commonalities as well as differences.

Film Global: This project is a partnership between NSS and Gosford Council Youth Services (Erina youth Centre or Erina Hub) and the CALD community, who regularly present international and multicultural films at Erina Hub. The project promotes unity, harmony, diversity and a general strengthening of the community. The film nights have been held monthly with different ethnic communities hosting each evening. Each community group provides food from their country of origin and shares cultural performances, a cultural display table and short documentary relating to their ethnicity before the start of the movie. The Gosford Council Youth services assist the groups with funding to prepare food, with the cost of entry being a gold coin donation. Groups represented have been Turkey, Italy, China, Thailand, France and Iran.

In addition close working relationships were formed with many groups in a range of capacities such as special events All Fresco Flicks, Harmony Day and Refugee Days. The project supported clients and communities by providing information, passing on relevant news, publications and assisting with venues for community meetings. The groups assisted by the project include French, Italian, Indian and Chinese.

Events that NSS participated or assisted in organizing included

Harmony Day. The week 'kicked off' with the photo competition that was organized in partnership with the Green Point Community Centre with the member for Gosford opening the competition. Celebrations at Warnervale and Mary Mackillop Catholic Primary Schools incorporated multicultural performances, talks, multicultural plays and a workshop for students. Other collaborative events were at San Remo Neighbourhood Centre, Gosford's Kibble Park – many hundreds participating with feedback surveys indicating a phenomenal success, and engaging a community member to speak at Interrelate Harmony Day.



Harmony Day at Warnervale Primary School

Refugee Day: Several Refugee Celebrations were held in conjunction with Green Point Community Centre, Gosford/Narara Community Centre and Gosford Council youth Services. Green Point community Centre featured a documentary about torture and trauma and the reasons people seek asylum. A number of guest speakers and performers also presented. Gosford / Narara Community Centre commenced with a documentary, followed by a multicultural breakfast, with guest speakers from Amnesty International and performances from the Chinese and French communities. NSS celebrated with presenters from Amnesty International and performances from the Iranian and Chinese communities. This was followed by a multicultural lunch.

“Playing around the world” Program: has proved a great success for children, parents, grandparents and workers to continue the journey across the world meeting people and learning about other's cultures whilst playing. The purpose of the project is to link the culture and experience from different members of Ethnic communities to a range of children's activities with the main goal of the Project to bring families together to share ideas, experience friendship and give children the opportunity to learn through play.

The project has produced culturally appropriate materials for children encompassing areas such as free play, craft, play dough, dance and music, story time, traditional food and games. Information sessions were held in collaboration with workers from different organisations promoting their services and programs in the area, like Department

of Human Services, Uni 4 you, Preparing for disaster, Women's Health Centre, TAFE. The "Playing Around The World" program has travelled from Australia to Colombia, Italy, Mexico, China, Taiwan, Spain, Kenya, Fiji, New Zealand, Russia, Japan, Argentina, Canada, Croatia. The Program took place at venues across the Central Coast: every Tuesday at Blue Haven School as Community Centre, every Thursday at The Entrance Community Centre and every second Monday at Narara/ Gosford Community Centre

AFL Multicultural Program The program aims to provide people from diverse cultures with an opportunity to be involved in AFL. This year NSS helped to organised a bus with people from India, New Zealand, China, Panama, Taiwan, Africa, Argentina as well as people of Indigenous backgrounds to participate in the Many Cultural Games at Homebush. NSS supported the Australia Post AFL Multicultural School Program by approaching schools and organising weekly clinics. At the conclusion of the activities a student from each school was selected as the AFL Ambassador in order to help with promotion. Students who participated in the AFL Program were presented with Certificates and show bags.

Network Participation

- Cultural Day at the Northern Woman Health Centre
- Multicultural Expo
- Health Week
- Health Expo
- Dementia forum for Spanish Speaker with Central Coast Disability
- AFL Multicultural Program
- All Fresco Flicks
- Central Coast Connect Day
- White Ribbon Breakfast,
- Multicultural Day at St Edwards College
- Peninsula Link
- Chinese Festival
- TAFE Mental Health Week
- Central Coast Disability Network Access and Equity Advisory Committee
- Central Coast Multicultural Interagency
- Multicultural Advisory committee at Wyong Council
- Cultural Shift Symposium Presentation
- Triple P training and practitioner
- CALD Domestic Violence Committee
- Meet the Mayor
- Multicultural Day at schools
- 16 Days White Ribbon Day

Thanks go to NSS management and the Central Coast team for their support and continuous encouragement.



Brighter Futures Program

Early Intervention Program

Zenaida Edmunds & Desie Erhart



Funded by

Department of Family and Community Services, Community Services

Northern Settlement Services Brighter Futures Program provides the home visiting component of the program to CALD families with young children.

Brighter Futures (BF) Program is an intensive and preventative program to support vulnerable families with young children up to 8 years of age, where children are considered at risk of significant harm. BF Program is delivered by non – government agencies and the lead agency is Samaritans Foundations servicing families in Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas. The program is voluntary and takes referrals from government and non – government agencies as well as self-referrals.

Families eligible to be in the program are; families in domestic violence situation, families that are having drug and alcohol problems and families where one or both parents or carers have mental illness.

BF Program supports families to access child care, parenting classes, social, health, education and other services that are needed to build the family's capacity and skills to be able to care for their children.

Family's goals are developed by the family with the BF Case Manager and are written in the Family Case Plan, which is reviewed every 3 months to monitor achievements and identify new goals. The family could be in the program for a maximum of 2 years. The role of the home visitor is to provide home visits on a weekly basis and more if needed; to assist the family achieved their goals.

The support includes accessing child care, referrals to relevant services such as parenting classes, playgroups, homework support, financial counselling, general health, hygiene and other specialist services. It also includes role model positive parenting to the parents, positive social interactions within the family, guiding children's behaviour in a positive and effective way, provide strategies for parents to use in guiding children's behaviour, and establishing routines with the children, preparing healthy meals and lunches for the children.

Last year, we home visited 8 families, the families are from Liberia (2x), Mauritania, Bangladesh, Iraq, Japan, Thailand and Afghanistan.

- Total No. of Home Visits: 131
- Total No. of Visiting Hours: 223 hours
- Total No. of Adults (Parents/Carers) Supported: 21
- Total No. of Children Supported: 30

Issues Addressed:

Child Development	35
Child Care Placement	11
Transport	23
Playgroup Access	26
Diet/ Nutrition/School Lunches	19
Health/Hygiene	31
Housing/Accommodation	15
Financial Counselling	7
Family Relationship	17
English Language Support	15
Social/Community Participation	27
After School/Vacation Activities	11
Behavioural Problems	23
Establishing Children's Daily Routine	11
Organised Interpreter	10
Support Visa Inquiry	9
Contacted Repair Service	1
Course Inquiry/Education	15
Total	306

Other activities participated in:

BF bi-monthly Partner's Meetings, NSS Welfare Team Meetings, NSS Staff meetings and Staff Development, Harmony Day Celebration, Multicultural Services Expo.

Trainings attended:

Triple P, Discrimination Laws, Conference – Law Pathways, Community and University Partnerships.

Another project supported this year is the establishment of Multicultural Playgroups in Raymond Terrace and Singleton, this is in partnerships with First Chance and Hunter Prelude and funded by Family and Community Services.

The Brighter Futures Program has continued to provide much needed support to vulnerable CALD background families. It has been a very busy and satisfying year, and another rewarding year of the Brighter Futures Program. Desie and I would like to thank our colleagues, Pet, our Welfare Team Manager, our CEO, Lulu, the Admin staff and the NSS Board for their support.

Parenting & Life Skills



Funded
by
Department of Social Services



FAHCSIA Parenting & Life Skills

Helen Buchanan

Funded by
Department of Social Services

The Program offers opportunities to develop life skills & capacity engagement through parenting and cultural development and targets refugee / humanitarian entrants and CALD families who are disadvantaged, isolated and vulnerable. Some of these families are experiencing hardships from the effects of torture and trauma, domestic violence, alcohol abuse and physical and psychological crisis in their settlement in Australia.

The diverse emerging refugee groups continue to evolve and change over the life of the program. Due to funding constraints First Chance Early childhood has not attended this financial year, but they have left us with resources and a wealth of information to continue the work. Families attending are from Ethiopia, Bangladesh, Iran, Japan & Afghanistan. We have again been blessed with excellent volunteer support for this program and we continue to see tremendous changes with behaviours and learning in the Children.

Overall this program met the objectives to ensure parents and children increase connections and social networks, improve family networks, assist in developing skills for families where abuse and neglect are a part of their life, increase the awareness of safety in families, provide a culturally safe learning environment and improve child development.

Activities undertaken:-

Providing activities to children to support their development and providing parents with relevant information about the benefits of play, painting, water play, sand play and play dough.

Providing stories, songs and games to develop children's language.

Providing art/craft activities to develop children's creativity and express their feeling through art.

Providing music and movement to create children's body awareness and music for rest and relaxation.

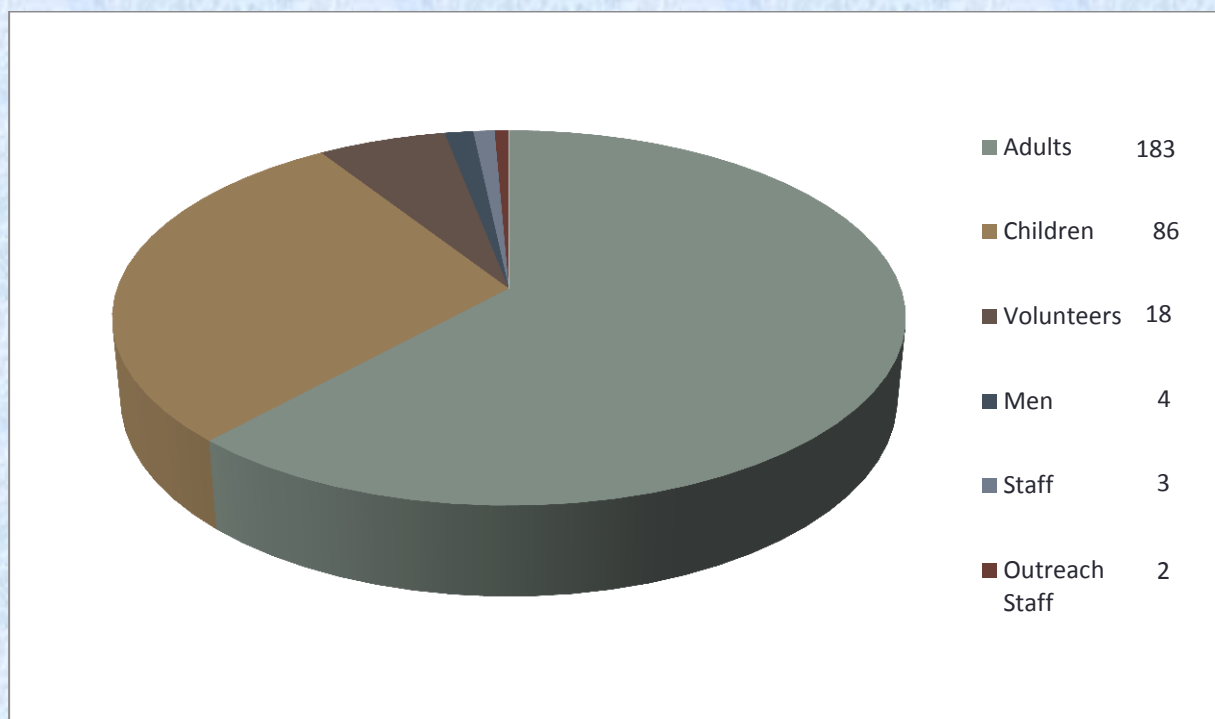
Establish routine with the children during group time and role model positive interaction in guiding children's behaviour i.e. Sharing, taking turns, using appropriate words, respecting others and develop empathy.

Men's Program

This year our men's program has successfully been running with small numbers but great outcomes. Project after project has been completed and the support from our handyman volunteer has proved to have provided positive role modelling and very practical skills activities around painting and small building projects that have seen a couple of the participants getting some small paid jobs through their communities.

Topics such as appropriate behaviour toward women in Australia, acceptable boundaries alongside some anger management and communication strategies, as well as working on CVs have been really received well.

Members within various communities have noticed greater confidence, self-esteem and decreased anger and frustration with the men that have attended the program. This is such a positive for the families and communities involved.



Youth Holiday Program

In 2013 – 2014 the program continues to run during school holidays on Thursdays. It is open to all families and we are still obtaining numbers up to 20 plus at each session. We continue to provide self-parenting and sibling parenting skills. Our focus is communication and fun activities. The children participate in cooking the lunch, making pastries, pizza, sandwiches and salads with the odd BBQ. We continue to provide links and create space for connections with other youth related agencies such as Relationships Australia, Interrelate and Salvation Army Youth Workers.

Eight sessions were undertaken with 30 adults and 120 children participating.

Some of our key Partnerships

This last 12 month period partnerships have been further developed and initiated with:

- Interrelate
- First Chance Early Childhood Service
- Newcastle Family Support Services
- New Horizons
- Relationships Australia
- Hunter New England Health
- NSW Police
- Newcastle Community Legal service



Complex Case Support (CCS)

Petrona Kelly

**Funded by
Department of Social Services**

Complex Case Support (CCS) provides specialised and intensive case management services to humanitarian entrants with complex and high needs. The program provides flexible, tailored and localised responses to the needs of all individuals in each case. Northern Settlement Services has a contract with the Department of Social Services to provide these services in Newcastle and the Hunter Region.

CCS is specifically targeted at supporting clients whose needs extend beyond the scope of other settlement services such as the Humanitarian Settlement Services (HSS) and the Settlement Grants Program (SGP). CCS is designed to work in partnership with other settlement and mainstream services to address the significant barriers these clients face in settling in Australia.

Complex Needs may include:

- Mental health (including torture and trauma)
- Physical health
- Family violence intervention
- Personal, grief or family relationship counselling
- Special services for children and youth
- Support to manage accommodation, financial or legal issues

Referral to Complex Case Support can be done by any organization or person such as:

- Service providers funded by the department
- Commonwealth, state or territory government agencies
- Community & health organizations
- Local church & community groups
- Volunteer groups
- Self-referrals

What Happens to a Referral?

The Department of Immigration & Citizenship (DIAC) assesses each referral and decides whether to accept it on a case-by-case basis. Each case that is accepted is allocated to a member of the Humanitarian Services Panel or another contracted service provider. The client is informed whether or not the referral has been accepted.

An Initial Needs Assessment (INA) is completed by the service provider. This is usually done by meeting the client face-to-face and discussing what they regard as their needs and the information in the referral. An INA may also be requested by the department to assist in deciding whether to accept a referral.

A Case Management Plan (CMP) is developed by the service provider for the accepted case. The CMP sets out the activities that will be undertaken to address the key issues identified through the referral and needs assessment of the client/s. Once the department agrees to the CMP, the service provider starts delivering the services through a case manager.

Eligibility: The main client group of CCS are:

- Refugee entrants
- Special Humanitarian Program entrants
- Protection visa holders and persons who hold or have held a Temporary Protection Visa
- CCS services may be delivered as short as crisis intervention of up to 14 days or as case management services up to six months.
- Clients are eligible for services for up to 5 years after their arrival in Australia, however flexibility may be shown to this timeframe in exceptional circumstances.

No referrals were made to the program this financial year.

Immigration Advice & Assistance





Immigration Advice & Assistance



Lulu Tantos, & Henriette de Jong
(Reg.#0318123) (Reg.#1462231)

Northern Settlement Services (NSS) has been operating a dedicated immigration law service for over 20 years to clients in Newcastle, the Hunter Region and its catchment area.

Our Registered Migration Agents provide professional, up-to-date advice and assistance to ensure that the immigration process goes as smoothly as possible for our clients. The area of immigration law in Australia is complex with different visas being available depending on clients' circumstances. We assist in:

- Temporary residence options
- Permanent visa options
- Refugee/humanitarian applications
- Appeals to the MRT/RRT and the Minister

During the last financial year approximately 400 clients from diverse backgrounds were seen by our Registered Migration Agents and over 500 instances of phone advice given.

Afghani clients constituted the largest number of individuals assisted, being the most recent refugee community settling in the area, with assistance given in preparing and lodging refugee/humanitarian applications and family visas for partners and children.

Country of Origin		
Afghanistan	Iran	Samoan
Australia	Italy	Saudi Arabia
Austrian	Kenya	South Africa
Brazil	Lebanon	Sudan
Canada	Liberia	Thailand
China	Macedonia	Tonga
Croatian	Malaysia	Uganda
DR Congo	Mauritania	UK
Ethiopia	Nepal	Ukraine
Fiji	New Zealand	Vietnam
Greece	Nigeria	Zimbabwe
India	Pakistan	
Indonesia	Philippines	

Finance & Administration Team Newcastle & Central Coast (CC)

As at 30th June 2014



Foong Rina Lachlan
Finance Manager



Samira Davoodi
Assistant Finance Officer



Kathy Rowarth
Assistant Finance Officer



Losa Uata
Administration
Officer



Natasha Holliday
Administration
Officer



Sharlene Huber
Administration Officer
Central Coast



Marilyn Perez Cabrera
Administration Assistant
Central Coast



Helen Buchanan
WH&S Consultant

Financial Statements





NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED
ABN 72 002 898 759

Financial Report
For the Year Ended
30 June 2014

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Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Directors' Report

30 June 2014

Your directors present their report on the company for the financial year ended 30 June 2014.

1. General information

Directors

The names of each person who has been a director during the year and to the date of this report are:

Names

Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM

William Simanowsky

Resigned: November 2013

Zoran Vasiljevic

Sania Young

Fr Nicholas Zervas OAM

Biko Syongoh

Christine Jordan

Anna Marendy

James Garvey

Carla Silva

Resigned: August 2013

Irina Lupish

Jon Chin

Esther Kalenga

Appointed: January 2014

Directors have been in office since the start of the financial year to the date of this report unless otherwise stated.

Company Secretary

The following person held the position of company secretary at the end of the financial year:

Sania Young is the representative of the Tartar Community and was appointed Company Secretary on 21 April 2010.

Principal Activities

The principal activity of Northern Settlement Services Limited during the financial year was the provision of welfare and information services.

No significant change in the nature of these activities occurred during the year.

Members guarantee

Northern Settlement Services Limited is a company limited by guarantee. In the event of, and for the purpose of winding up of the company, the amount capable of being called up from each member and any person or association who ceased to be a member in the year prior to the winding up, is limited to \$10 for each member, subject to the provisions of the company constitution.

At 30 June 2014 the collective liability of members was \$850 (2013: \$850).

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Directors' Report

30 June 2014

2. Business review

Operating Results

The surplus from ordinary activities after providing for income tax amounted to \$ 348,648 (2013: \$ 17,102).

3. Other Items

Significant Changes in State of Affairs

No significant changes in the company's state of affairs occurred during the financial year.

After balance day events

No matters or circumstances have arisen since the end of the financial year which significantly affected or may significantly affect the operations of the company, the results of those operations or the state of affairs of the company in future financial years.

Auditors Independence Declaration

A copy of the auditor's independence declaration as required under section 307C of the Corporations Act 2001 is set out at page 5.

Short & Long Term Objectives

Northern Settlement Services has developed a Strategic Plan with objectives, strategies and indicators to guide and monitor the work of the organisation. The short and long term objectives are achieved through leadership, support and advocacy for the Migrant Resources Network and reviewed at each Board meeting using financial and non financial key performance indicators. In this way, the organisation can continue to develop programs and activities across immigration areas that are responsive to member needs.

4. Director Information

Information on directors

Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM Board member since 1990

Dutch Community Representative
Special Responsibilities Director, Chairperson, Public Officer & Audit Committee

William Simanowsky Board member since 1992, resigned November 2013
Ukrainian Community Representative

Special Responsibilities Director

Zoran Vasiljevic Board member since 1996
Bosnian Community Representative

Special Responsibilities Director

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Directors' Report

30 June 2014

4. Director Information continued

Information on directors continued

Sania Young	Board member since 1998 Tartar Community Representative
Special Responsibilities	Director, Company Secretary, Audit Committee
Fr Nicholas Zervas OAM	Board member since 1999 Greek Community Representative
Special Responsibilities	Director
Biko Syongoh	Board member since 2007 African Community Representative
Special Responsibilities	Director, Audit Committee
Christine Jordan	Board member since 2008 Polish Community Representative
Special Responsibilities	Director, Treasurer, Audit Committee
Anna Marendy	Board member since 2008 Greek Community Representative
Special Responsibilities	Director
James Garvey	Board member since 2010 Local Businessman & Philanthropist
Special Responsibilities	Director, Assistant Treasurer, Audit Committee
Carla Silva	Board member since 2009 Social Worker, New England Health Service
Special Responsibilities	Director
Irina Lupish	Board member since 2010 Russian Community Representative
Special Responsibilities	Director, Vice Chairperson
Jon Chin	Board member since 2012 Local businessman
Special Responsibilities	Director, Assistant Secretary
Esther Kalenga	Appointed: January 2014
Special Responsibilities	Director

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Directors' Report

30 June 2014

4. Director Information continued

Meetings of Directors

During the financial year, 14 meetings of directors (including committees of directors) were held. Attendances by each director during the year were as follows:

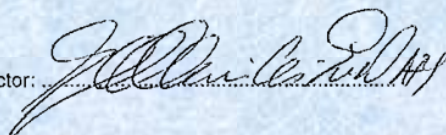
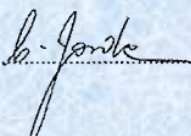
	Directors' Meetings		Audit Committee Meetings	
	Eligible to attend	Number attended	Eligible to attend	Number attended
Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM	12	10	2	2
William Simanowsky	6	3	-	-
Zoran Vasiljevic	12	7	-	-
Sania Young	12	7	2	-
Fr Nicholas Zervas OAM	12	6	-	-
Biko Syongoh	12	4	2	1
Christine Jordan	12	8	2	2
Anna Marendy	12	5	-	-
James Garvey	12	5	2	2
Carla Silva	1	1	-	-
Irina Lupish	12	6	-	-
Jon Chin	6	6	-	-
Esther Kalenga	4	4	-	-

5. Indemnifying Officers or Auditors

Insurance premiums paid for directors

The company has paid premiums to insure each of the directors against liabilities for costs and expenses incurred by them in defending any legal proceedings arising out of their conduct while acting in the capacity of director of the company, other than conduct involving a wilful breach of duty in relation to the company. The amount of the premium is not disclosed due to the terms of the insurance contracts and to protect commercially sensitive information of the company.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors:

Director:  Director: 

Dated 15 October 2014

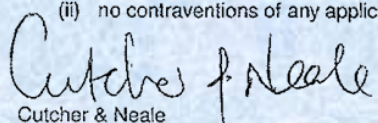
Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Auditors Independence Declaration under Section 307C of the Corporations Act 2001

I declare that, to the best of my knowledge and belief, during the year ended 30 June 2014 there have been:

- (i) no contraventions of the auditor independence requirements as set out in the Corporations Act 2001 in relation to the audit; and
- (ii) no contraventions of any applicable code of professional conduct in relation to the audit.



Cutcher & Neale
Chartered Accountants



M. J. O'Connor CA
Partner

9 October 2014

Newcastle

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Independent Audit Report to the members of Northern Settlement Services Limited

Report on the Financial Report

We have audited the accompanying financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited, which comprises the statement of financial position as at 30 June 2014, and the statement of surplus or deficit and other comprehensive income, statement of changes in funds and statement of cash flows for the year then ended, notes comprising a summary of significant accounting policies and other explanatory information, and the directors' declaration.

Directors' Responsibility for the Financial Report

The directors of the company are responsible for the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards and the *Corporations Act 2001* and for such internal control as the directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view and is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

Auditor's Responsibility

Our responsibility is to express an opinion on the financial statements based on our audit. We conducted our audit in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards. Those standards require that we comply with relevant ethical requirements relating to audit engagements and plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial report is free from material misstatement.

An audit involves performing procedures to obtain audit evidence about the amounts and disclosures in the financial report. The procedures selected depend on the auditor's judgement, including the assessment of the risks of material misstatement of the financial report, whether due to fraud or error. In making those risk assessments, the auditor considers internal control relevant to the company's preparation of the financial report, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the company's internal control. An audit also includes evaluating the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates made by the directors, as well as evaluating the overall presentation of the financial report.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinion.

Additional Scope Pursuant to the Charitable Fundraising Act 1991

In addition, our audit report has also been prepared for the Members of the company in accordance with Section 24(2) of the *Charitable Fundraising Act 1991*. Accordingly we have performed additional work beyond that which is performed in our capacity as auditors pursuant to the *Corporations Act 2001*. These additional procedures included obtaining an understanding of the internal control structure for fundraising appeal activities and examination, on a test basis, of evidence supporting compliance with the accounting and associated record keeping requirements for fundraising activities pursuant to the *Charitable Fundraising Act 1991* and Regulations.

It should be noted that the accounting records and data relied upon for reporting on fundraising appeal activities are not continuously audited and do not necessarily reflect after the event accounting adjustments and the normal year end financial adjustments for such matters as accruals, prepayments, provisioning and valuations necessary for year end financial statements preparation.

The performance of our statutory audit included a review of internal controls for the purpose of determining the appropriate audit procedures to enable an opinion to be expressed on the financial statements. This review is not a comprehensive review of all those systems or of the system taken as a whole and is not designed to uncover all weaknesses in those systems.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Independent Audit Report to the members of Northern Settlement Services Limited

Our audit opinion pursuant to the *Charitable Fundraising Act 1991* has been formed on the above basis.

Independence

In conducting our audit, we have complied with the independence requirements of the *Corporations Act 2001*. We confirm that the independence declaration required by the *Corporations Act 2001*, which has been given to the directors of Northern Settlement Services Limited, would be in the same terms if provided to the directors as at the time of this auditor's report.

Auditor's Opinion

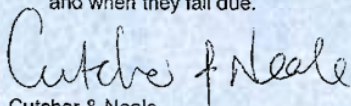
In our opinion the financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited is in accordance with the *Corporations Act 2001*, including:

- (a) giving a true and fair view of the company's financial position as at 30 June 2014 and of its performance for the year ended on that date; and
- (b) complying with Australian Accounting Standards and the *Corporations Regulations 2001*.

Audit Opinion Pursuant to the Charitable Fundraising Act 1991

In our opinion the financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited is in accordance with the *Charitable Fundraising Act 1991*, including:

- (a) the financial report and associated records have been properly kept during the period in accordance with the *Charitable Fundraising Act 1991* and the regulations;
- (b) monies received as a result of fundraising appeals conducted during the period have been properly accounted for and applied in accordance with the *Charitable Fundraising Act 1991* and its regulations; and
- (c) there are reasonable grounds to believe Northern Settlement Services Limited will be able to pay its debts as and when they fall due.



Cutcher & Neale
Chartered Accountants



M. J. O'Connor CA
Partner

Newcastle

16 October 2014

Northern Settlement Services Limited

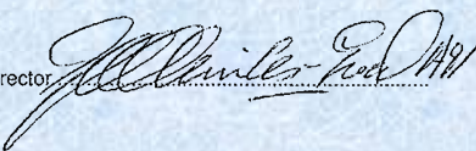
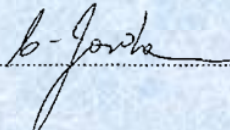
ABN 72 002 898 759

Directors' Declaration

The directors of the company declare that:

1. The financial statements and notes, as set out on pages 10 to 29, are in accordance with the *Corporations Act 2001* and:
 - (a) comply with Australian Accounting Standards; and
 - (b) give a true and fair view of the financial position as at 30 June 2014 and of the performance for the year ended on that date of the company.
2. In the directors opinion, there are reasonable grounds to believe that the company will be able to pay its debts as and when they become due and payable.

This declaration is made in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors.

Director  Director 

Dated 15 October 2014

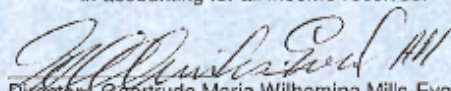
Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Declared Opinion Pursuant to the Charitable Fundraising Act 1991

I, Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers as a Director of Northern Settlement Services Limited declare, in my opinion:

- (a) the financial statements give a true and fair view of all income and expenditure of Northern Settlement Services Limited with respect to fundraising appeals;
- (b) the statement of financial position gives a true and fair view of the state of affairs with respect to fundraising appeals;
- (c) the provision of the *Charitable Fundraising Act 1991* and the regulations under the Act and the conditions attached to the authority have been complied with for the year ended 30 June 2014; and
- (d) the internal controls exercised by Northern Settlement Services Limited are appropriate and effective in accounting for all income received.



Director - Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers AM

Dated 15 October 2014

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Statement of Surplus or Deficit and Other Comprehensive Income

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

		2014	2013
	Note	\$	\$
Income	2	2,983,684	2,778,025
Finance costs	3	(18,378)	(28,084)
Employee benefits expense		(1,707,009)	(1,672,353)
Depreciation and amortisation expense	3	(58,253)	(83,550)
Occupancy expense		(94,089)	(85,936)
Administration expense		(241,168)	(278,836)
Program expense		(516,137)	(612,164)
Surplus / (deficit) before income taxes		348,648	17,102
Income tax expense		-	-
Surplus / (deficit) after income taxes		348,648	17,102
Other comprehensive income		-	-
Total comprehensive income		348,648	17,102

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements.

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Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Statement of Financial Position

As At 30 June 2014

	Note	2014 \$	2013 \$
ASSETS			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	6	1,964,072	1,771,514
Trade and other receivables	7	101,706	38,560
Other assets	8	17,355	9,681
Total current assets		2,083,133	1,819,755
Non-current assets			
Property, plant and equipment	9	930,846	993,144
Total non-current assets		930,846	993,144
TOTAL ASSETS		3,013,979	2,812,899
LIABILITIES			
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	10	116,540	121,415
Short-term borrowings	11	37,837	60,455
Employee benefits	12	165,873	216,309
Other liabilities	13	78,126	152,433
Total current liabilities		398,376	550,612
Non-current liabilities			
Long-term borrowings	11	271,893	285,332
Employee benefits	12	79,022	60,915
Total non-current liabilities		350,916	346,247
TOTAL LIABILITIES		749,292	896,859
NET ASSETS		2,264,687	1,916,040
FUNDS			
Accumulated funds		2,264,687	1,916,039
TOTAL FUNDS		2,264,687	1,916,039

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements.

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Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Statement of Changes in Funds

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

2014		Accumulated Surplus	Total
		\$	\$
Balance at 1 July 2013		1,916,039	1,916,039
Total comprehensive income		348,648	348,648
Balance at 30 June 2014		2,264,687	2,264,687

2013		Accumulated Surplus	Total
		\$	\$
Balance at 1 July 2012		1,898,937	1,898,937
Total comprehensive income		17,102	17,102
Balance at 30 June 2013		1,916,039	1,916,039

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Statement of Cash Flows

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

	Note	2014 \$	2013 \$
Cash from operating activities:			
Receipts from government grants		2,631,766	2,617,489
Receipts from clients		428,194	378,305
Payments to suppliers and employees		(2,863,256)	(2,862,348)
Interest received		52,720	68,510
Interest paid		(18,378)	(28,084)
Net cash provided by / (used in) operating activities	15	<u>231,046</u>	<u>173,872</u>
Cash flows from investing activities:			
Proceeds from sale of plant and equipment		-	2,272
Purchase of property, plant and equipment	9(a)	(2,431)	(113,991)
Net cash used by investing activities		<u>(2,431)</u>	<u>(111,719)</u>
Cash flows from financing activities:			
Repayment of borrowings		(36,057)	(48,515)
Net cash used by financing activities		<u>(36,057)</u>	<u>(48,515)</u>
Net cash increase / (decreases) in cash and cash equivalents		192,558	13,638
Cash and cash equivalents at beginning of year		1,771,514	1,757,876
Cash and cash equivalents at end of year	6	<u>1,964,072</u>	<u>1,771,514</u>

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements.

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Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

1 Summary of Significant Accounting Policies

The financial statements are for Northern Settlement Services Limited as an individual entity, incorporated and domiciled in Australia. Northern Settlement Services Limited is a not-for-profit company limited by guarantee.

(a) Basis of Preparation

The financial statements are general purpose financial statements that have been prepared in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards (including Australian Accounting Interpretations), authoritative pronouncements of the Australian Accounting Standards Board and the *Corporations Act 2001*.

Australian Accounting Standards set out accounting policies that the AASB has concluded would result in financial statements containing relevant and reliable information about transactions, events and conditions to which they apply. Material accounting policies adopted in the preparation of these financial statements are presented below and have been consistently applied unless otherwise stated.

The financial statements have been prepared on an accruals basis and are based on historical costs, modified, where applicable, by the measurement at fair value of selected non-current assets, financial assets and financial liabilities.

(b) Comparatives

When required by Accounting Standards, comparative figures have been adjusted to conform to changes in presentation for the current financial year.

(c) Property, Plant and Equipment

Each class of property, plant and equipment is carried at cost or fair value as indicated less, where applicable, any accumulated depreciation and impairment losses.

Property

Land is measured at cost.

Buildings are measured at cost less accumulated depreciation and impairment losses.

Plant and equipment

Plant and equipment are measured on the cost basis less accumulated depreciation and impairment losses. Cost includes expenditure that is directly attributable to the asset.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

1 Summary of Significant Accounting Policies continued

(c) Property, Plant and Equipment continued

Depreciation

The depreciable amount of all fixed assets including land and buildings but excluding freehold land, is depreciated on a straight-line basis over the asset's useful life to the company commencing from the time the asset is held ready for use. Leasehold improvements are depreciated over the shorter of either the unexpired period of the lease or the estimated useful lives of the improvements.

An asset's carrying amount is written down immediately to its recoverable amount if the asset's carrying amount is greater than its estimated recoverable amount.

Gains and losses on disposals are determined by comparing proceeds with the carrying amount. These gains and losses are included in the statement of surplus or deficit and other comprehensive income.

The depreciation rates used for each class of depreciable assets are:

Class of Fixed Asset	
Plant and Equipment	10% - 40% PC / DV
Motor Vehicles	22.5% PC
Leasehold improvements	14.3 - 20% PC
Buildings	4% PC

The assets' residual values, depreciation methods and useful lives are reviewed, and adjusted if appropriate, at the end of each reporting period.

(d) Financial Instruments

Initial recognition and measurement

Financial assets and financial liabilities are recognised when the entity becomes a party to the contractual provisions of the instrument. For financial assets, this is the equivalent to the date that the company commits itself to either the purchase or sale of the asset (i.e. trade date accounting is adopted).

Financial instruments are initially measured at fair value plus transactions costs, except where the instrument is classified 'at fair value through profit or loss' in which case transaction costs are expensed to profit or loss immediately.

(i) Loans and receivables

Loans and receivables are non-derivative financial assets with fixed or determinable payments that are not quoted in an active market and are subsequently measured at amortised cost.

Loans and receivables are included in current assets, except for those which are not expected to mature within 12 months after the end of the reporting year.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

1 Summary of Significant Accounting Policies continued

(d) Financial Instruments continued

(ii) Financial liabilities

Non-derivative financial liabilities (excluding financial guarantees) are subsequently measured at amortised cost. Fees payable on the establishment of loan facilities are recognised as transaction costs of the loan.

Borrowings are classified as current liabilities unless the company has an unconditional right to defer settlement of the liability for at least 12 months after the reporting date.

Impairment

Objective evidence that a financial asset is impaired includes default by a debtor, evidence that the debtor is likely to enter bankruptcy or adverse economic conditions. At the end of each reporting period, the company assesses whether there is objective evidence that a financial asset has been impaired through the occurrence of a loss event.

Impairment losses are recognised through an allowance account for loans and receivables in the statement of surplus or deficit and other comprehensive income.

Where a subsequent event causes the amount of the impairment loss to decrease (e.g. payment received), the reduction in the allowance account (provision for impairment of receivables) is taken through profit and loss.

Derecognition

Financial assets are derecognised where the contractual rights to receipt of cash flows expires or the asset is transferred to another party whereby the entity no longer has any significant continuing involvement in the risks and benefits associated with the asset. Financial liabilities are derecognised where the related obligations are either discharged, cancelled or expired. The difference between the carrying value of the financial liability extinguished or transferred to another party and the fair value of consideration paid, including the transfer of non-cash assets or liabilities assumed, is recognised in profit or loss.

(e) Cash and Cash Equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents include cash on hand, deposits held at call with banks and other short-term highly liquid investments with original maturities of three months or less.

(f) Employee Benefits

Provision is made for the company's liability for employee benefits arising from services rendered by employees to balance date. Employee benefits that are expected to be settled within one year together with benefits arising from wages and salaries and annual leave which will be settled after one year, have been measured at their nominal amount. Other employee benefits payable later than one year have been measured at their nominal amount.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

1 Summary of Significant Accounting Policies continued

(f) Employee Benefits continued

The company's accounting policy is to recognise long service leave benefits accruing to employees from the commencement of their employment.

Given the nature of the company's operations, the Directors have decided to recognise this liability immediately to ensure adequate funds are accumulated for the eventual payment of these entitlements. This accounting policy ensures that the costs of these entitlements are recognised directly against the grant for which the employee works.

Contributions are made by the company to an employee superannuation fund and are charged as expenses when incurred.

(g) Trade and other payables

Trade and other payables represent the liability outstanding at the end of the reporting period for goods and services received by the company during the reporting period which remain unpaid. The balance is recognised as a current liability with the amounts normally paid within 30 days of recognition of the liability.

(h) Revenue

The company recognises revenue when the amount of revenue can be reliably measured, it is probable that future economic benefits will flow to the entity and specific criteria have been met for each of activities as discussed below.

Grant revenue

Grant revenue is recognised in the statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income when the entity obtains control of the grant, it is probable that the economic benefits gained from the grant will flow to the entity and the amount of the grant can be measured reliably.

When grant revenue is received whereby the entity incurs an obligation to deliver economic value directly back to the contributor, this is considered a reciprocal transaction and the grant revenue is recognised in the statement of financial position as a liability until the service has been delivered to the contributor, otherwise the grant is recognised as income on receipt.

Donations

Donations and bequests are recognised as revenue when received.

No amounts are included in the financial statements for services donated by volunteers.

Interest revenue

Interest revenue is recognised on a proportional basis taking into account the interest rates applicable to the financial assets.

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Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

1 Summary of Significant Accounting Policies continued

(h) Revenue continued

Provision of services

Revenue recognition relating to the provision of services is recognised on delivery of service to the client.

All revenue is stated net of the amount of goods and services tax (GST).

(i) Borrowing costs

Borrowing costs directly attributable to the acquisition, construction or production of assets that necessarily take a substantial period of time to prepare for their intended use or sale, are added to the cost of those assets, until such time as the assets are substantially ready for their intended use or sale.

All other borrowing costs are recognised in profit or loss in the period in which they are incurred.

(j) Goods and Services Tax (GST)

Revenues, expenses and assets are recognised net of the amount of GST, except where the amount of GST incurred is not recoverable from the Australian Taxation Office. In these circumstances the GST is recognised as part of the cost of acquisition of the asset or as part of an item of the expense. Receivables and payables in the statement of financial position are shown inclusive of GST.

Cash flows are presented in the cash flow statement on a gross basis, except for the GST component of investing and financing activities, which are disclosed as operating cash flows.

(k) Unexpended Grant Funds

The liability for unexpended grant funds is the unutilised amounts of grants received on the condition that specified services are delivered or conditions are fulfilled in a future period.

(l) Leases

Lease payments for operating leases, where substantially all of the risks and benefits remain with the lessor, are charged as expenses on a straight-line basis over the life of the lease term.

(m) Income taxes

No provision for income tax has been raised as the company is exempt from income tax under Div 50 of the *Income Tax Assessment Act 1997*.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

1 Summary of Significant Accounting Policies continued

(n) Critical accounting estimates and judgments

The directors evaluate estimates and judgments incorporated into the financial statements based on historical knowledge and best available current information. Estimates assume a reasonable expectation of future events and are based on current trends and economic data, obtained both externally and within the company.

Key estimates - Impairment of plant and equipment

The company assesses impairment at the end of the reporting year by evaluating conditions specific to the company that may be indicative of impairment triggers. Recoverable amounts of relevant assets are reassessed using value-in-use calculations which incorporate various key assumptions.

(o) Impairment of non-financial assets

At the end of each reporting year, the company reviews the carrying values of its tangible and intangible assets to determine whether there is any indication that those assets have been impaired. If such an indication exists, the recoverable amount of the asset, being the higher of the asset's fair value less costs to sell and value in use, is compared to the asset's carrying value. Value in use is either the discounted cash flows relating to the asset or depreciated replacement cost if the criteria in AASB 136 'Impairment of Assets' are met. Any excess of the asset's carrying value over its recoverable amount is expensed to the statement of surplus or deficit and other comprehensive income.

Where the future economic benefits of the asset are not primarily dependent upon the asset's ability to generate net cash inflows and when the company would, if deprived of the asset, replace its remaining future economic benefits, value in use is determined as the depreciated replacement cost of an asset.

(p) Adoption of new and revised accounting standards

During the current year, the company adopted all of the new and revised Australian Accounting Standards and Interpretations applicable to its operations which became mandatory.

(q) New accounting standards for application in future periods

Certain new accounting standards and interpretations have been published that are not mandatory for 30 June 2014 reporting periods. On assessment of these new standards and interpretations there is no identified impact for Northern Settlement Services Limited.

(r) Authorisation of financial statements

The financial statements were approved and authorised for issue by the Board of Directors on 15 October 2014. The Directors have the power to amend the financial report at any time.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

2 Revenue

	2014 \$	2013 \$
Operating activities		
- Operating grants	2,711,202	2,600,587
- Services revenue	74,404	79,937
- Donations	24,377	24,873
- Other revenues	33,304	4,118
- SSI Hosting Fees	87,677	-
	<u>2,930,964</u>	<u>2,709,515</u>
Non operating activities		
- Interest received	52,720	68,510
Total Revenue	<u>2,983,684</u>	<u>2,778,025</u>

3 Surplus from Ordinary Activities includes

(a) Expenses

Depreciation and amortisation of non current assets:		
Plant and equipment	31,493	60,992
Leasehold improvements	496	723
Buildings	23,264	21,835
	<u>58,253</u>	<u>83,550</u>
Finance costs	<u>18,378</u>	<u>28,084</u>
Rental lease payments on operating lease	<u>20,906</u>	<u>24,522</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

4 Key Management Personnel Compensation

The totals of remuneration paid to the key management personnel of Northern Settlement Services Limited during the year are as follows:

	2014	2013
	\$	\$
Short-term employee benefits	187,112	235,932
Post-employment benefits	10,616	27,566
	<u>197,728</u>	<u>263,498</u>

5 Auditors' Remuneration

Remuneration of the auditor of the company for:

- Auditing or reviewing the financial report	13,850	10,900
- Audit of grant funding acquittals	5,600	8,000
- Other assurance services	4,875	2,975
	<u>24,325</u>	<u>21,875</u>

6 Cash and Cash Equivalents

Cash on hand	1,049	301
Cash at bank	1,159,118	1,184,109
Short-term bank deposits	803,905	587,104
	<u>1,964,072</u>	<u>1,771,514</u>

Reconciliation of Cash

Cash at the end of the financial year as shown in the cash flow statement is reconciled to items in the balance sheet as follows:

Cash and cash equivalents	<u>1,964,072</u>	<u>1,771,514</u>
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Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

7 Trade and Other Receivables

	2014	2013
	\$	\$
CURRENT		
Trade and other receivables	101,706	38,560

8 Other Assets

CURRENT		
Prepayments	17,355	9,681

9 Plant and Equipment

LAND AND BUILDINGS		
At cost	934,196	934,196
Less accumulated depreciation	(84,667)	(61,603)
Total land and buildings	849,329	872,593
PLANT AND EQUIPMENT		
Plant and equipment		
At cost	207,610	239,735
Less accumulated depreciation	(154,128)	(165,008)
Total plant and equipment	53,482	74,727
Motor vehicles		
At cost	240,925	239,244
Less accumulated depreciation	(213,259)	(194,506)
Total motor vehicles	27,666	44,738
Leasehold improvements		
At cost	45,090	45,090
Less accumulated depreciation	(44,721)	(44,004)
Total leasehold improvements	369	1,086
Total plant and equipment	81,517	120,551
Total property, plant and equipment	930,846	993,144

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

9 Plant and Equipment continued

(a) Movements in Carrying Amounts

Movement in the carrying amount for each class of property, plant and equipment between the beginning and the end of the current financial year

	Land and Buildings \$	Plant and Equipment \$	Motor Vehicles \$	Leasehold Improvements \$	Total \$
Current Year					
Balance at the beginning of year	872,593	74,727	44,738	1,086	993,144
Additions	-	750	1,681	-	2,431
Disposals - written down value	-	(6,255)	-	(221)	(6,476)
Depreciation expense	(23,264)	(15,740)	(18,753)	(496)	(58,253)
Carrying amount at the end of year	849,329	53,482	27,666	369	930,846
Prior Year					
Balance at the beginning of year	869,501	25,239	66,154	1,809	962,703
Additions	24,927	72,161	16,903	-	113,991
Depreciation expense	(21,835)	(22,673)	(38,319)	(723)	(83,550)
Carrying amount at the end of year	872,593	74,727	44,738	1,086	993,144

10 Trade and Other Payables

	2014 \$	2013 \$
CURRENT		
Trade payables	36,390	25,604
Sundry payables and accrued expenses	80,150	95,811
	<u>116,540</u>	<u>121,415</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

11 Borrowings

	2014 \$	2013 \$
CURRENT		
Secured liabilities:		
Bank loan	<u>37,837</u>	<u>60,455</u>
NON-CURRENT		
Secured liabilities:		
Bank loan	<u>271,893</u>	<u>285,332</u>
A registered mortgage exists over 8 Chaucer Street, Hamilton.		
(a) Total current and non-current secured liabilities		
Bank loan	<u>309,730</u>	<u>345,787</u>

12 Employee Benefits

CURRENT		
Employee benefits	<u>165,873</u>	<u>216,309</u>
NON-CURRENT		
Employee benefits	<u>79,022</u>	<u>60,915</u>

13 Other Liabilities

CURRENT		
Unexpended grant funds	<u>78,126</u>	<u>152,433</u>

14 Segment Reporting

The company operates in the services industry wholly within New South Wales.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

15 Cash Flow Information

(a) Reconciliation of Cash Flow from Operations with Surplus after Income Tax		
	2014	2013
	\$	\$
Accumulated Surplus	348,648	17,102
Non-cash flows in surplus		
Depreciation & Amortisation	58,253	83,550
Net (profit) / loss on disposal of property, plant and equipment	6,476	(2,272)
Changes in assets and liabilities		
(Increase)/decrease in trade and term receivables	(79,295)	30,562
(Increase)/decrease in prepayments	(7,674)	2,111
(Increase)/decrease in grant funds	(58,157)	6,318
Increase/(decrease) in trade payables and accruals	(4,876)	6,559
Increase/(decrease) in provisions	(32,329)	29,942
	<u>231,046</u>	<u>173,872</u>
(b) Credit standby arrangements with banks		
Loan facility	430,884	430,884
Amount utilised	(309,730)	(345,787)
	<u>121,154</u>	<u>85,097</u>

16 Capital and Leasing Commitments

(a) Operating Lease Commitments

Non-cancellable operating leases contracted for but not capitalised in the financial statements

Payable - minimum lease payments		
- not later than 12 months	8,280	14,854
- between 12 months and 5 years	-	8,280
	<u>8,280</u>	<u>23,134</u>

The office lease(s) are non cancellable lease(s) with one and three year terms, with rent payable monthly in advance. Contingent rental provisions within the lease agreement require the minimum lease payments shall be increased by CPI.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

17 Financial instruments

The main risks Northern Settlement Services Limited is exposed to through its financial instruments are credit risk, liquidity risk and market risk consisting of interest rate risk.

The company's financial instruments consist mainly of deposits with banks, local money market instruments, short-term investments, accounts receivable and payable and bank loans.

The totals for each category of financial instruments, are as follows:

	2014	2013
	\$	\$
Financial Assets		
- Cash and cash equivalents	1,964,072	1,771,514
- Trade and other receivables	101,706	38,560
Total financial assets	2,065,778	1,810,074
Financial Liabilities		
Financial liabilities at amortised cost		
- Trade and other payables	116,540	121,415
- Borrowings	309,730	345,787
- Unexpended Government grant funds	78,126	252,636
Total financial liabilities	504,396	719,838

Financial risk management policies

The Board of Directors has overall responsibility for the establishment of Northern Settlement Services Limited's financial risk management framework. This includes the development of policies covering specific areas such as credit risk, liquidity risk and market (interest rate) risk.

Risk management policies and systems are reviewed regularly to reflect changes in market conditions and Northern Settlement Services Limited's activities.

The day-to-day risk management is carried out by Northern Settlement Services Limited's finance function under policies and objectives which have been approved by the Board of Directors. The Senior Finance Officer has been delegated the authority for designing and implementing processes which follow the objectives and policies. This includes monitoring the levels of exposure to interest rates and assessment of market movements.

The Board of Directors receives monthly reports which provide details of the effectiveness of the processes and policies in place.

Northern Settlement Services Limited does not actively engage in the trading of financial assets for speculative purposes.

Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

Financial risk management policies continued

Mitigation strategies for specific risks faced are described below:

(a) Credit risk

Exposure to credit risk relating to financial assets arises from the potential non-performance by counterparties of contract obligations that could lead to a financial loss to Northern Settlement Services Limited and arises principally from Northern Settlement Services Limited's receivables.

Northern Settlement Services Limited deals predominately with state and federal government bodies. Due to the public nature of these entities Northern Settlement Services Limited does not perform a formal credit assessment process however the company does take into account past experience and other factors.

(b) Liquidity risk

Liquidity risk arises from the possibility that Northern Settlement Services Limited might encounter difficulty in settling its debts or otherwise meeting its obligations related to financial liabilities. The company manages this risk through the following mechanisms:

- preparing forward-looking cash flow analysis in relation to its operational, investing and financial activities which are monitored on a monthly basis;
- monitoring undrawn credit facilities;
- obtaining funding from a variety of sources;
- maintaining a reputable credit profile;
- managing credit risk related to financial assets;
- only investing surplus cash with major financial institutions; and
- comparing the maturity profile of financial liabilities with the realisation profile of financial assets.

Typically, Northern Settlement Services Limited ensures that it has sufficient cash on demand to meet expected operational expenses for a period of 60 days.

The available funds to the company are discussed in note 15.

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

(c) Market risk

Market risk is the risk that the fair value or future cash flows of a financial instrument will fluctuate because of changes in market prices.

Interest rate risk

Exposure to interest rate risk arises on financial assets and financial liabilities recognised at the end of the reporting period, whereby a future change in interest rates will affect future cash flows or the fair value of fixed rate financial instruments.

Sensitivity analysis

The following sensitivity analysis is based on the interest rate risk exposures in existence at the end of the reporting period.

An increase of 100 basis points or a decrease of 50 basis points would have affected equity and net surplus / (deficit) by the amounts shown below. This analysis assumes that other variables are held constant.

	Surplus / (deficit)	
	100 basis points increase	50 basis points decrease
2014	16,533	(8,266)
2013	14,254	(7,127)

The movements in the surplus are due to higher interest rates from variable rate debt and cash balances.

The net exposure at the end of the reporting period is representative of what Northern Settlement Services Limited was and is expecting to be exposed to at the end of the next twelve months.

The sensitivity analysis is performed on the same basis as in 2013.

(d) Net Fair Values

There is no material difference between the carrying value of the assets and liabilities and the fair values of the assets and liabilities.

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Notes to the Financial Statements

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

18 Related Parties

Transactions between related parties are on normal commercial terms and conditions no more favourable than those available to other parties unless otherwise stated.

Transaction with related parties:

A company controlled by the CEO's son, supplied computer equipment and IT services to Northern Settlement Services Limited on normal commercial terms and conditions no more favourable than those available to other persons unless stated.

19 Additional Disclosures Required By the Charitable Fundraising Act 1991 and Charitable Fundraising Regulation 1998

The company has received donations from registered clubs under the Community Development and Support Scheme (CDSE). This does not constitute a fundraising appeal for the purposes of the Charitable Fundraising Act and as such no additional disclosure is made.

20 Company Details

Registered office

The registered office and principal place of business of the company is:

Northern Settlement Services Limited
8 Chaucer Street
Hamilton NSW 2303

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Compilation Report

30 June 2014

We have compiled the accompanying special purpose financial statements of Northern Settlement Services Limited, which comprise the detailed income statement for the period ended 30 June 2014. The specific purpose for which the special purpose financial statements have been prepared is to provide information relating to the performance of the entity that satisfies the information needs of the Board of Directors.

The Responsibility of the Directors

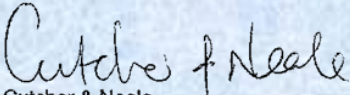
The directors are solely responsible for the information contained in the special purpose financial statements and have determined that the basis of accounting used is appropriate to meet their needs and for the purpose that the financial statements were prepared.

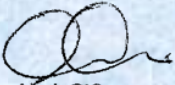
Our Responsibility

On the basis of the information provided by the directors we have compiled the accompanying special purpose financial statements in accordance with the basis of accounting and APES 315: *Compilation of Financial Information*.

Our procedures use accounting expertise to collect, classify and summarise the financial information, which the directors provided, in compiling the financial statements. Our procedures do not include verification or validation procedures. No audit or review has been performed and accordingly no assurance is expressed.

The special purpose financial statements were compiled exclusively for the benefit of the directors. We do not accept responsibility to any other person for the contents of the special purpose financial statements.


Cutcher & Neale
Chartered Accountants


M. J. O'Connor
Partner

Newcastle
16 October 2014

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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Detailed Income Statement

For the Year Ended 30 June 2014

	2014	2013
	\$	\$
Income		
Donations received	24,377	24,873
Grants received	2,696,885	2,600,587
Interest received	52,720	68,510
Client fees	74,404	69,938
Profit / (loss) on sale	-	2,272
Complex Case revenue	1,886	10,000
SSI Hosting Fees	87,678	-
Sundry	45,735	1,846
Total Income	2,983,684	2,778,025
Expenses		
Administration fees	4,944	14,553
Advertising	3,958	6,561
Audit and accounting fees	22,250	24,275
Bank charges	4,636	1,903
Bad debts	-	-
Catering, function	16,542	19,520
Cleaning	12,877	14,362
Computer expenses	13,572	18,033
Consultant Fees	56,263	14,768
Depreciation and amortisation	58,253	83,550
Donations	3,035	701
Electricity	12,574	10,094
Insurance	37,176	38,352
Interest paid on mortgage	18,378	28,084
Interpreting fees	2,455	18,863
Motor Vehicle	40,922	38,463
Office furniture	559	-
Office supplies	7,587	9,306
Postage	8,341	8,400
Printing and Stationery	18,775	20,399
Programme Costs	502,579	599,901
Refugee Week	1,069	60
Rent	20,906	24,522
Repairs and Maintenance	2,017	915
Security	858	1,013
Seminar and training	14,986	11,053
Staff amenities	10,232	12,016
Subscriptions and membership	6,214	5,671
Sundry expenses	6,945	5,852
Telephone and internet	43,768	35,030
Travel	7,770	24,568
Volunteer expenses	25,679	25,787
Wages	1,608,951	1,563,863
Workers Compensation	39,966	80,484
Total Expenses	2,635,036	2,760,922
Operating surplus/(deficit)	348,648	17,102